Brief Notes on GENESIS

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FOREWORD

Brief Notes On Genesis is a unique collection of thoughts on interesting persons, places and things from the book of "beginnings"! Each selection stimulates respect for the perfection of the Word and the wisdom of Its Divine Author.

"Now all these things happened unto them for examples, and they are written for our admonition, upon whom the ends of the ages are come." (I Corinthians 10:11)

These notes on Genesis were taken from the interleafed Bible of the late Dr. Harry Bultema. Dr. Bultema pastored the Berean Church of Muskegon, Michigan for 30 years. Bible studies circulated in periodicals, booklets, and books carried his influence throughout the Midwest and to distant points of the United States.

WHAT IS THE RIGHT RELATION OF REASON AND REVELATION?

1. Reason as a gift of God is used to convince us that we have a revelation. What the eye is to the telescope, reason is to revelation. In gazing through the telescope we do not first pluck out the eye, no, we use it to see the wonders of the firmament and in the same way we use reason to see the wonders of revelation.
2. Reason is used in explaining the revelation. A being without reason would not be benefited in the least by a revelation.
3. Reason must also apply the revelation and carry it forth to the ends of the earth.
4. Never may reason be coordinated with revelation as a second or even a secondary source of truth. Reason is per se no truth, but only an instrument of truth at best. Nor may reason ever be put in the exalted seat of the judge to be a critic of revelation.

Shall we ever see the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ? God said of old in Exodus 33:20, there shall no man see Me and live. See also Deut. 4:15; Job 9:11; 23:8. Yes, but in the adorable face of our Lord Jesus Christ. In His face shines all the glory of God the Father. Apart from Christ, not any man hath seen the Father, John 6:46. Christ said to the multitudes: "Ye have neither heard his voice nor seen his shape;" and He said to Philip: "He that hath seen me hath seen the Father." God is a Spirit, John 4:24; Luke 24:39. This eternal power and Godhead are according to Rom. 1:20 "invisible things." In the same sense as He is called *eternal* and *immortal* He is said to be *invisible* in I Timothy 1:17. "No man hath seen God at any time," John 4:12. From Col. 1:15 we know that Christ is the image of the invisible God. We shall not feel it in heaven as something amiss or lacking when we do not see the Father as a separate person from the Lord Jesus, because we shall behold all the glory of the Triune God in the wonderful face of our adorable Savior, the same face that one dripped with spit and blood, commingled for our sins. Praise His name! No man hath seen, *nor can see* God as such, since He dwells in an inapproachable light, but in Christ we see God, I Timothy 6:16. How is it consistent with God's immensity and omnipresence when we read that He is time and again represented as located in certain places, e.g. heaven, Jerusalem etc. and also that He comes and goes? This has reference to His manifestations of glory and mercy and the coming and departing of the Messiah. What has often been regarded as anthropomorphisms and anthropopathisms are in reality realistic description of the first and second comings of the Messiah.

Must the first chapters of Genesis be taken as history or as symbol and poetry? Genesis 1:4.

As history, because:

1 - It is related as history.

2 - It is understood by the Bible itself as history.

3 - Christ authenticated it as history.

4 - The Apostles understood it as history, Romans. 5:11-19.

5 - Revelations 20-22 form the counterpart of it to show that God made re-creation and full restoration of the fallen creation.

6 - Only unbelief in its many forms has a desire to depart from the historical idea.

7 - The whole plan of salvation is based upon the historical reality of these chapters.

Where was Eden located? Genesis 2:10-15.

There is hardly a place on earth that has not been thought of the location of Eden. We must bear in mind that the description given of it seems to point to the location as it was after the flood. Two considerations compel us to that view. The description would lose all point on the other supposition. Then the names of the countries given are such as must have been given after the deluge. Who was Havilah? A son of Cush and a grandson of Ham and thus a great-grandson of Noah, Genesis *10:7.* And Ethiopia is Cush in Hebrew. Hence we may safely infer that the description applies to a location subsequent to the deluge. Hiddekel is thought to be Tigrus, a tributary of the Phrat or Euphrates. The little prefix *Eu* means water, so that the Euphrates means literally the waters of the Phrat. Also the rivers Pison and Gihon are mentioned, and it is not known definitely where these are.

IN THE BEGINNING CREATED ELOHIM; Gen. 1:1

God begins His wonderful Word with a grammatical error. He uses a plural subject with a singular verb and we need not be a grammarian to know that this is all wrong.

Why did God use a plural noun, where He could have taken the often-used singular *Eloha* just as well. Just as well? Let us see. In the Hebrew there are three nominal forms according to the numbers: the singular, dual, and plural the singular would with this noun be *Elohah,* the dual or two persons would have been *Elohaim,* two Gods, while the plural is *Elohim.* Strange that God who hates all polytheism and tritheism should put the plural name in the beginning of His Word. No, He did not put his name in the very beginning. He put in the original in the *beginning* first and then He put even before the plural name for God, Elohim, the singular verb *bara,* i.e. *He created.* We have right in the first verse then the mystery of a single Being acting as one and yet there was not one *Eloah,* nor two *Elohain,* but three *Elohim,* the Father, Son, and the Holy Spirit.

That this is a deep foundation truth of the Scriptures we can see on every page. God consistently honors in all His Word what He has stated here in the first verse. He never deviates a hairbreadth from it.

HINTS OF TRINITY ON THE FIRST PAGE OF THE BIBLE

Genesis 1:26, 27

In sharp contradistinction to the creation as a whole, God counselled in regard to the creating of man. He could not counsel with the angels, for they are His creatures and have no wisdom which they did not receive from Him. That God should seek counsel from the devil and his

satraps is altogether unthinkable. With who then did He thus seek counsel in regard to man's creation? It could have been only the Son and the Spirit one with Him in the holy triune Being. We know for certain that no creature was His counsellor, Romans 11:34. This is the thought of all trinitarian theologians. Note carefully: Let us make man, Genesis 1:26, 27. In *our* image, plurality of Persons.

God created man in *His* own image, here is one Being. In the image of God created *He* him, one Being. In the image of *God* made He man, 9:6, one Being.

Here is clearly a plurality of Persons as appears from the plural *us* and *our*. This is not a plural or majesty for the Hebrews did not have this. Nor can it be a plural or intensity for then there is no reason for the mixture of the plurals and singulars. The only logical conclusion we can come to is that the Son as the Creator speaks here to the Father and to the Spirit whence the us and the our. Then the triune God created man in His own image. The three Persons were one Being and man was created in the image of God as it literally says. The word *"tselem"* occurs thirty-four times. In Daniel *2* and 3 alone it is used seventeen times of the world-image and the golden image in the valley of Dura.

After these three plurals, we read in verse *27:* "So God created man in *His* own image." These are not merely the plurals of majesty, because it has been shown sufficiently that such plurals did not exist in the Hebrew. In all the decrees of the Scriptures we read the singular as: *I, Nebuchadnezzar*. The simplest interpretation is that we have here a plurality of Persons in the one divine Being. The words "tselem" "image," and "likeness," “demuth" do not refer to God's attributes but to outward form, as the Companion Bible correctly affirms. The Rabbies claim that Elohim has taken an outward form in order to create. Comp. Colossians 1:15; Revelation 3:14.

CREATION - Genesis 1

In the sublime first sentence God refutes the proud philosophical systems of man as Pantheism, Atheism, Evolutionism, Dualism. Deism, Materialism, Idealism, Emanationism, Agnosticism, Polytheism, Rationalism, Eddyism, Russellism, Fatalism and practically every "ism."

Evolutionism, which by the way has spiritually wrecked modern education, contradicts all History, all Scripture, all Biology, all Geology, all facts, and all common sense. It assumes spontaneous generation or life from nothing. In Geology it is a rule that the older and younger fossils are found promiscuously. Survival of the fittest runs counter to facts for in the last two world wars the unfit remained, millions with sight and limbs shot away. Evolution is highly dangerous to morality for if man is only an animal, there is not much reason why he should not be killed, if he troubles us. It breaks down on every point and has innumerable gaps. The atoms refuse to give birth to a cell, the vegetable cell refuses to give birth to an animal cell. Animals never have brain power, no vocal organs to sing, no moral power of conscience, nor artistic power to appreciate beauty or humor. They cannot laugh, and never have spiritual power to pray and worship. Evolution has failed to explain the origin of things, or the sterility of hybrids or why the one-celled never become the multi-cellular creatures, why the lower forms persist now for nearly five thousand years as we can

see in the museum of Gizeh; and why the cold blooded reptiles never become warm-blooded animals, and the oviparous snakes never become viviparous. Evolution breaks down at every step, and with all its pretence it offers not a shred of proof. Certainly there is growth in all nature, but no transmutation of species, nor progress and development. One of the finest books ever written against Evolutionism is *"After Its Kind,"* by Byron C. Nelson, published by Augsburg Publishing House, Minneapolis. Get it for your son or daughter.

DOES GOD'S IMAGE ALSO INCLUDE THE HUMAN BODY?

Genesis 2:7

Yes, God is highly interested in our bodies.

He lets our bodies suffer, linger, pine away and die, so that it sometimes seems as if He is not interested in them. However, He is highly interested in them, even if He does not always heal them. Consider the following facts:

1.-He wondrously made them: Would He not be interested in His own making?

2-Though marred by sin and under the effects of the curse and decay and death, yet as a ruin it is still a marvelous work of God and an inexhaustible object of study. A scholar published some time ago a book entitled Man the Unknown, in which he says that an ignorance about man is profound. Every organ of the body is an inexhaustible subject of study and scientific research.

3.-It is maintained by God as an *anthropos,* i.e. as a body turned up and looking up. All animals look down, man alone can look up.

4.-Christ honored our bodies by taking a real body from the flesh and blood of Mary, sin excepted, that in His body He might carry our sins on the tree.

5.-Christ paid the price of His blood for our bodies as well as for our souls.

6.-Our bodies are now ministering as holy temples for Him.

7.-They shall soon be metamorphosed, i.e. changed like unto His own body of glory, Philippians 3:21.

8.-Then they shall fully manifest the glory of God's pneumatic bodies, swayed by the Holy Spirit.

EDEN, GENESIS 2:8

This word means *delight, pleasure.* It is the descriptive term of the delightful garden spot. In Amos 1:5 we read of the house of *Eden,* which according to many scholars refers to the valley of Baalbec between the Lebanon and Antilebanon Mountains. The natives there believe even now that the Garden of Eden was located in that beautiful and fruitful valley. They conduct you to the spot where Adam was created, where Cain killed Abel, and they show you the tomb of the latter. In Arabia at the entrance of the Red Sea we have a city by

the name of Aden, which is derived from Eden, for some thought that Eden lay in *Arabia felix*.

The town of *Adena* in Cilicia was also called Eden, because of its charming situation. Near Tripoli in Syria is another town called Eden, where some have also located lost Paradise. However, to none of these places, charming as they may be, will the marks of Moses apply as given by Moses in the beginning of Genesis. Whenever man found a beauty spot on this sin cursed earth, he called it with pathos and homesickness for lost Paradise Eden.

Eden is lost, and fallen man has often tried to restore it but he has never succeeded, and he never will succeed. Nevertheless Eden shall be restored on earth. Some day they shall say: "This land that was desolate is become like the garden of Eden." Ezekiel 36:35.

WHAT IS THE TREE OF LIFE? GENESIS 2:9

A hard question. It is mentioned three time in Genesis 2 and 3. In Proverbs 3:18 wisdom is called a tree of life; Proverbs 11:30 we read that the fruit of the righteous is a tree of life. In 15:4 a wholesome tongue is called a tree of life. In Revelations 2:7 the overcomer is promised to eat of the tree of life in the midst of the Paradise of God, while in Revelations 22:2 its leaves are said to be for the healing of the nations. Hence we see that the tree is found in the beginning, the middle and the end of the Book. Many think it had only a physical significance and that it served as some sort of exhilarant. Man theologians think however that it had a supernatural power to prolong life. Some have a magical and miraculous theory. The physical theory of Kuyper and others is wrong, because all trees fed and exhilarated life. Then there would have been no reason to keep man from it. The reference in Proverbs show that it had to do with man's moral perfection. It was a common tree but evidently set apart for a symbolic and typical reason. God made the tree apparently a type and figure of Christ the Redeemer.

GARDEN, GENESIS 2:9

The Bible speaks fifty times of a garden in the Old Testament. "Gan" in Hebrew and its derivatives have the same generic meaning as their English equivalent garden. The word "ganab" meant originally to steal from a garden, which evidently was often done. We read of a

Garden of Eden, Genesis 2:9; 10, 15, 16; 3:1.

Garden of the Lord, Genesis 13:10.

Garden of herbs, Deuteronomy 11:10.

Garden of Uza, II Kings 21:26.

Garden inclosed, Cant. 4:12.

Garden watered, Isaiah 58:11.

Garden of God, Ezekiel 28:13; 31:8, 9.

Gardens by the river's side, Numbers 24:6.

Garden that hath no water, Isaiah 1:30

Garden of nuts, Cant. 6:11.

Garden house, II Kings 9:27.

Garden of the King, II Kings 25:4; Jeremiah 39:4.

Even as early as Job's day we read of a class of workmen as gardeners, Job 27:18. God made man in a garden and He remade man in a garden called Gethsemane where Christ suffered untold agonies and was strengthened by an angel from heaven. He was also buried in a garden, and in a garden He also arose. A watered garden was a symbol of fertility, Isaiah 58: 11; Jeremiah 31:12, whereas a waterless garden was a desert, Isaiah 1:30. Speaking figuratively then the garden of Gethsemane was a well watered garden. It was the King's garden when the King of glory Himself was pressed in the oil press, which is the meaning of Gethsemane.

BDELLIUM, GENESIS 2:12

This word is found only in Genesis 2:12 and Numbers 11:7 and as the translators did not translate, we may safely conclude that they did not know what it was. The Septuagint translates the latter by "krystallos," which means "ice," but there is no reason to think that it refers to a mineral at all. Some treat it under the minerals and some under the botany of the Bible. While some regard it as a precious stone, others regard is as the gum of the Balsomodendron. Josephus and the Vulgate think of a sort of aromatic gum. Scholars do not know the etymology of the word "bedolach." In all probability it is from the verb "badal," divide, separate.. Modern medical science speaks of "Bdellium" as a gum, resin from a tree of India, and another kind from a palm of Africa. It, therefore, must have some medicinal value, and this also points to a plant.

MAN'S ORIGINAL TASK IN PARADISE-GENESIS 2:15

Man had, as we see it, a sixfold task:

1.-He had a *dominion* over fish, fowl, and all cattle and creeping things. Christ shall have His dominion over land and sea.

2.-He had to be *fruitful* and multiply. This was also the first duty of Noah in the new world after the deluge. Christ shall see His seed, Isaiah 53.

3.-He had to *replenish* the earth The earth had been made desolate and empty through Satan's fall, and now man was to act remedially and restoratively as God's co-worker. Man failed in this, as we see strikingly exemplified in his tower of Babel scheme, but what man

failed to do Christ did, for He rose and ascended for the very purpose "that He might fill all things." Ephesians 4:10. He replenishes all things now empty.

4.-He had to *subdue* the earth. He had to rule the earth as its king, but lo and behold, the bugs and the worms rule and subdue him in life and death, on and under the earth. What man did not do Christ soon will accomplish.

5-He had to *dress* the garden of Eden. He had to be God's gardener of beauty. Gardening is still very healthful for the body and restful for the nerves. As the tree of life Christ will beautify Paradise.

6.-He had to *keep* the garden of Eden. He had to be God's watchman on duty. The Bible speaks of three Edens : the garden of Eden; Eden near Damascus and Eden in Mesopotamia. From the course of the rivers here mentioned it is most generally held that it must have been in the highlands of Armenia, but wherever it may have been man has failed, Christ never fails. Man has failed in every dispensation and he failed under the finest condition in the first, and he miserably fails in this day of grace.

NAMES ACCORDING TO THE NATURE OF THINGS

Genesis 2:19

Many names in Hebrew are highly characteristic of the nature of the things or creatures named. A boy is called "Nahar" for his liveliness. A camel is so called, according to some, because its name meaning "recompense," it repays in service good or ill treatment. It is with the elephant remarkable for remembering and revenging an injury.

A scorpion is "akrab" (our crab) derived from two words meaning to kill the father, and ancient and modern naturalists assure us that this ill-natured beast often destroys its own parents. We are assured, however, in Genesis 2:19 that "whatsoever Adam called every living creature that was the name thereof." The verb "was" is not in the original and this sentence should and does say that the name given by Adam is the name thereof, which then turns up to this that Adam gave by divine inspiration and illumination the names to these animals in pure Hebrew such as they still had in Moses' day. Consequently, the conclusion is inescapably legitimate that Adam spoke Hebrew in Paradise before the Fall. There is no question and doubt that Hebrew was the pure and primeval speech of man, and the Phoenician, Arabic, and other Oriental languages are all corrupt forms of Hebrew.

THE DEEP SLEEP-Genesis 2:21

A deep sleep fell on Adam. Genesis 2:21.

A deep sleep fell on Abram. Genesis 15:12.

A deep sleep fell on Saul and his men. I Samuel 26:12.

A deep sleep fell on Eliphaz. Job 4:13.

A deep sleep fell on Elihu. Job 33:15.

The slothful man is cast into a deep sleep. Proverbs 19:5.

Israel of Naiah's day had a spirit of deep sleep. Isaiah 29:10.

The Hebrew word *tardemah,* used in these seven passages is not the usual word for "sleep" and does not denote the common nightly slumber but a very special repose brought on by God or by a spirit. The word "shenah" is the regular word for sleep and "shakab" means to lie down. In contrast to these words "tardemah" is not a spontaneous and natural sleep but a stupor that is brought on for some purpose as everyone of these seven passages clearly shows. In the last two passages the purpose is evidently punishment. In the last analysis the word *torpor is* a distant cousin of the word *Tardemah.* Our *tardy* and its various forms are also related. The Hebrew *tardemah* is invariably a revelation of God's mercy or might and judgment.

HE TOOK ONE OF HIS RIBS-Genesis 2:21, 22

The Hebrew is not an abstract and abstruse language, but concrete and realistic in the highest degree. To illustrate this briefly with the word "rib," "tzela." The *sides* of the ark are its *ribs.* The sides of the tabernacle are the *ribs* of the tabernacle. Simei went along on the hill's side, *rib,* to curse David and throw sand at him. Yes, but he walked on the hill's *rib.* The *side* boards, planks, and leaves of the temple were all *ribs.* When we read eleven times of the side chambers of Ezekiel's wonderful temple, then these are all but *ribs.* The ribs are on the sides of our being, and so anything on a side was to the Hebrew a rib. In all this it may very well be that we find in all these rib-texts allusions to the making of woman as a help for man out of his side. We know that the apostle Paul draws some fundamental truths from the same fact in I Corinthians 11 and I Timothy 2:12-15. All through His wonderful Book, God lays profound thoughts in the most simple words.

EVE--Genesis 2:21-25

After God made man He rested but after He made woman we never read that either God or man rested. Eve came forth from a deep sleep, *tardemah,* not the usual but a specially induced sleep. Our word *tardy,* slow, sluggish, sleepy, is of the family etymologically. Eve is bone of his bone, flesh of his flesh, a saying that became proverbial in Israel for close relationship and in Eph. 5:30, Paul applies it to Christ and the Church, alluding to this rib and flesh of Adam the first. Here was identity: flesh of flesh. Eve was formed by God Himself. God, and God alone is all through creation's story, the only agent and prime mover. He is the author of all, except of the chaos, the darkness, and the deep, for these were caused by Satan.

Paul carries a real argument for the place of the woman in the Church and in relation to man upon the simple fact that Adam was made first. God seems to have meant with this that man should ever be first, though man in condescending graciousness lets the lady be first. For the same reason man is not woman's helpmeet but woman man's helpmeet. These simple

creation facts form with God the basic and unalterable principles of home, church, society and state; but man in his conceit always thinks that he knows better than God, and he degrades himself to be an helpmeet to woman. Eve was after her completion presented to Adam as his helpmeet, joy and delight, not his toy or his slave, as we see in Islam and Paganism. Taken from Adam's heart region she is to represent the tender, sweet heart life of man and thereby be his complement, comrade, and glory, and she always is, provided both man and wife know their God-given place. Eve shared the man's name for together they are called *the man, HaAdam,* and so Christ and the church form together the new man. Eve also rules with him over fish and fowl and quadruped and with his rule and authority she gets his love, his presence, his beauty, his strength, his guidance, his work; in short they have married in communion of goods.

AS ADAM-Genesis 3:6

They, like men, have transgressed the covenant, Hosea 7:9. Every item essential to a covenant is contained in the transaction between God and Adam, and Hosea gives it the name *berith,* covenant. The phrase *like men Ke Adam* should be *as Adam.* The same phrase is thus rendered in Job 31:33 "If I covered my transgression *as Adam."* The tremendous story of the fall was never lost. The phrase as we have it in the A.V. is senseless for how could they transgress the covenant otherwise than as men. Animals never transgress. That is man's glory and shame exclusively. This phrase becomes laden with riches when we translate it *as Adam,* because then we see that Hosea's contemporaries rebelled against God with open eyes and determined *will as Adam* did. This text is a conclusive proof for the ancient Reformed doctrine of the covenant of works. Adam could have reached by means of obedience and works but he failed. Did God now drop His holy demand of obedience to Him? This could never be for He is God and His command was just as holy as His holy Being. Where the first Adam failed, there the last Adam has taken upon Him to become obedient unto the death of the cross in behalf of all the new humanity which He represented. In many churches and pulpits they still want to toil and slave under the ancient covenant of works, totally oblivious of the fact that Christ has fully taken over and met all God's demands and that His merits are now given gratis to all who take Christ by faith.

THEY SEWED FIG LEAVES TOGETHER-Genesis 3:7

As soon as man had fallen away from God and run away from Him, he tried to help himself with nature and culture as it is still this day. The fig leaves represent nature; the sewing, culture. He had wrecked himself body and soul, and now he proceeds to spoil God's nature by tearing off branches with the leaves from the trees. In Nehemiah 8: 15 the same word "aleh," rendered "leaf," is translated five times "branches." Man evidently had lost his garment of light. All the animals still have living garments; the quadrupeds have skin and thick long hair, wool, or fur; and the birds have their feathers; but man has no living garment left. Sin made him a wretched nudist and brought a blush to his cheeks. But the run-away from God cannot very well run to God for a covering. No, he endeavors to help himself. He

spoils the fruit trees and tears off the branches in order to cover his nakedness. That they were God's trees, planted by His hand, and grown by His sun, air, and dew made no difference to him. Sin brings indifference to the property of others, most of all to that of God; and the sinner goes on a rampage of wreckage and ruin. Here in miniature, at the end of history in magnitude. One leaf or branch could not cover him and so he *sewed* them together. He feels that he needs covering and shelter and he is determined to help himself. Combined with nature shall be culture. God had taught him to sew since there was no man to teach him, but sin, too, made him a clumsy tailor. However. God had not taught him to despoil nature and combine nature and culture for a self-covering. Man, also as a pupil, goes wrong, as we see. When God used in 8:11 a leaf, an "aleh," it was as a symbol of life and peace and resurrection, just the very opposite of man's destruction.

APRONS FOR SELF-COVERING-Genesis 3:7

Sinful man felt at once that he needed a covering and a hiding place. Man began with the covering of leaves, he will end with the cry for a covering of mountains, Revelation 6:16. It was undoubtedly in allusion to Adam's self-covering that Solomon said: "He that covereth his sins shall not prosper." Man's shame till this day reminds man of his sin and misery and that he has lost his robe of innocence. Whenever man sees himself as God sees him, man abhors himself as unclean. Asaph called himself a beast, a "behemoth"; David called himself a partridge and flee; Mephibosheth, a dead dog; Israel condemned himself as unclean; and Peter called himself a sinful man. The fig leaves were a covering of nature and culture but not of blood. Man's best works apart from Christ are but filthy rags, Isaiah 64:6. No man ever made a better attempt in self-covering than Paul and yet he found it utterly vain and vile, Philippians 3:4-6. All efforts of the sinner to make himself presentable to God and fit for heaven apart from Calvary are fig leaves. Whenever man covers himself and his sin, God always uncovers him sooner or later, Hebrews 4:13. Man's apron did well until God appeared to the nudist tailors.

Man could not cover himself nor could he hide himself. Nature's trees do not hide from God, but Calvary's tree does. Adam sought in reality two hiding places; the trees and Eve. He tried to blame his wife and even God for giving him such a helpmeet.

Note that at the beginning of history man covered himself with fig leaves, at the end of history he screams to the mountains and the hills to cover his nakedness, Revelation 6: 16. The blood of Christ is the perfect covering before the all-piercing eye of God.

THE PROTEVANGELIUM-Genesis 3:15

The serpent or "nachash" was first judged by the great judge, and it was Satan judged in him and yet in such a way that this unique creature was forever remanded to a most degraded state and shorn of all power and temptation. That God put enmity between Satan and the woman clearly reveals the secret purpose of Satan to affiliate himself and unite himself and his seed in an intimate alliance or even amalgamation. Satan is the oldest exponent and

protagonist of a universal brotherhood between light and darkness. He started this brotherhood scheme 6,000 years ago and he has been busy with that ever since. God foiled his plan by drawing sharply the lines of demarkation, and by declaring the two irreconcilable. So far from brotherhood or even a friendly neutrality, there is to be an exclusive antagonism. But time is given to Satan to persecute and to antagonize and impede the seed of the woman. All through the Word we see this deadly enmity as in Cain and Abel, in Cain's race and the line of Seth, Enoch and those that walked away from God; Noah and his contemporaries, Shem and Ham, Isaac and Ishmael, Jacob and Esau, Israel and Amalek, Moses and Jannes and Jambres, and Israel and the world empires. In Romans 16:20 i.e. 30 years after Christ had gone to heaven at God's right hand, this promise of God in Genesis 3:15 was not yet fulfilled because the Apostle speaks there of the bruising of Satan as still future. Three times did our Lord speak of the offspring of vipers, the brood of the serpent with clear allusions to this first promise. The antithesis is still going on today and will only come to an end in Revelations 20 with the expulsion and imprisonment of satan in the abyss.

BRUISE--Genesis 3:15

The word for "bruise" is "shuph" which really means to lie in wait for," suggesting as Dr. Feinberg says, the idea of a prolonged conflict with the element of expectancy; and indeed a long and dismal conflict it has been now for nearly six thousand years. After Satan in some unknown and mysterious way for us had rebelled against God in heaven, God wanted a long history of sin and salvation of Satan and the Holy Seed of the woman. The demons themselves know that God has a set time for their punishment, for they ask our Lord: "Art thou come to torment us before the time?" It is generally thought that the Savior of the cross bruised the head of Satan, but there His heel was bruised, Satan was not bruised, because during this age of grace, he is still *god* of this age and Romans 16:20 makes plain that in the coming of Christ he will be bruised under the feet of the saints. It is a strange mistake many theologians make when they claim that the cross fully fulfilled the protevangelum, or mother promise. This minimizes His future work far more than it exalts His work on the cross. In fact it never glorifies the Lord, if we unduly exalt His past work at the expense of His future performances. Not only Scripture but even history makes it clear that the final account with Satan has yet to be settled. Revelations 12 and 20 sufficiently show how this old account of extremely long standing will be settled by the Lord of glory and His Angels. Not in this age of grace, but then also shall He destroy all the works of Satan of which the world is still full. When we now look around us, we see Satan in majority and in the high seats of influence everywhere, but his day and reckoning are near and all that cling to him will go to the place prepared for him and his angels.

HE SHALL RULE OVER THEE-Genesis 3:16

In regard to the life of woman and her life in wedlock, in the family, and in the church, the Apostle Paul finds the formative, and regulative principles in the very beginning of the Scriptures. These bed rock principles are six:

1.-Man is made not *of* the woman, but the woman of man, I Corinthians 11:1-16.

2.-Man was not created *for* the woman, but the woman for man.

3-Adam was *first* formed, then Eve, Timothy 2:9-15.

4.-Adam was *not deceived,* but the woman was deceived and in transgression, I Timothy 2:9-15.

5.-Man was to have authorative *rule* over woman and woman not over man.

6.-Woman is commanded to be *submissive* as also saith the law and the gospel; I Corinthians 14:34; Ephesians 5:22-33; Colossians 3:18.

These six simple principles still stand in majestic power, and the violation of them has gone a long way to wreck the great American home and society. It is rebellion at the very mainspring of life and is also ruinous for the whole educational system, for if the children daily see their mother in rebellion they can only grow up as rebels against divine authority in home, school, church and state. And the saddest of all is that the preachers do not have the intestinal fortitude to preach against this female iniquity.

THORNS-Genesis 3:18

Thorns are a curse, at least a part of the curse pronounced upon the earth because of sin, Genesis 3:18. Israel's land sanctified by God's presence was largely free from this curse of thorns, but sin put Israel out of the land and the thorns in, as we see in Isaiah 7:24; 34:13. Thus it is in our day. In the Holy Land the so-called "Spina Christi" grows everywhere. Its thorns are sharp and two inches in length. Our blessed Lord, made sin for us, was crowned with these "being made a curse for us," and thus He redeemed Israel from the curse of the law, Galatians 3:13. It is remarkable that there are no less than seventeen Hebrew words used for thistles and thorns. Palestinian and Hebrew scholars have given up all hope of unraveling the distinctions and various shades of these words. It is said at least fifty genera and over two hundred species of such plants are armed with some sort of prickles, thorns or stinging hairs. Gideon thrashed the men of Succoth with thorns, judges 8:16. It can readily be seen how this would be a most painful punishment.

There are no less than twenty-two words rendered in our versions "thorn," "brier," "thistle" - a clear proof by the way that God's original curse upon the earth has become a frightful reality. The wicked are often compared to the thorns as tokens and results of the curse. Dried cow and camel dung was the common fuel in the East, and the quickness with which the thorns were consumed made this a graphic picture of the sudden end of the fools, Psalm 118: :12. The slothful man is a hedge of thorns, Proverbs 15:19; 22:5. The laughter of fools is compared to the crackling of thorns under a pot, Ecclesiastics 7:6. Desolation is to be overgrown with thorns, Proverbs 24:31. When we remember that thorns are the bitter fruit of the curse and that the fools and the wicked are often compared to the thorns, then it becomes so uniquely rich to think that our Saviour was crowned with thorns. He was literally put under the law not only, but also under the curse and then on Calvary literally also under the wrath of God, all for the purpose that we should never come under the curse and the flaming wrath of God.

IN THE SWEAT OF THY FACE SHALT THOU EAT BREAD

Genesis 3:19

The word *zeah is* used only in this place. Some great Hebrew scholars claim that the English *sweat* and the Dutch *zweet* are direct derivatives from this word. Even if this should prove to be untrue, the prophecy here pronounced has proved itself true throughout the ages until our very day. The stream of humanity was poisoned at its very source and the streams of sweat in all lands are corroborative proof of man's original rebellion from God. Every sweat drop sparkles forth man's guilt and God's penalty. The last Adam also sweat in the garden but it was no sweat that trickled from His hallowed brow but blood in order that we might inherit some day a sweatless, bloodless world of peace and glory.

COATS OF SKINS-Genesis 3:21

The word for "coats" is "chethoneth." It is used twenty-eight times and is the word used for the many colored "coat" of Joseph and for the embroidered "coat" of the high priest. This word made its entrance at an early age into the language of the Greeks and became "chilton," meaning "tunica," "tunic," the general word for "coat" or upper garment. As the most erudite scholar of languages, W. Jones remarked long ago, in multitudes of Greek words, where the Lexicons force strange sense upon them, their deduction from the Hebrew is evident and natural. In a word like this also both the form and sense perfectly correspond and point to the identity in origin.

Man's aprons would not do, when God came on the scene. They originated from man, from sin, and from nature and culture. God wanted covering through death and blood. It has often been remarked that we do not read in this connection of sacrifice or any slain animal. True but this is clearly presupposed, since it is altogether inconceivable that God who hates things that have died of themselves to such an extent that He even forbade the eating of the strangled in the Noaic covenant, would here have covered our first parents with something that had died.

The word for skin is Or. The girdle of leather is a girdle of or, skin. When Satan said, "Skin for skin," he said, "or for or." For Job said: "I am escaped with the or, skin, of my teeth," and, "after my *or*, skin, worms destroy my body." The word is related to the word for light, bright, seeing the skin is always shining.

God said! let there be light, *or*. He Himself is clothed with a garment of light, *or*, and now it is nothing short of marvelous that He clothes man in the garment of *or*. His garment was of life poured out. It was typically a covering of blood, of the blood of the lamb that taketh away the sin of the world. At the same time it was a garment of light for God holds onto His fallen creature and signifies prophetically that He some day will be like Him clothed in the garment of light, shining above the sun and the stars. Oh wondrous love, condescending love to wayward rebels!

FIG LEAVES

How silly for man to cover himself with such a flimsy covering!

The shaken leaf stands in Leviticus 26:36 for the least little noise and in job 13:25 for the slightest motion to and fro. Especially do leaves symbolize the quick fading and withering, Psalms 1:3; Isaiah 1:30; 34:4; 64:5; Jeremiah 8:13; Ezekiel 47:12. We all do fade as a leaf, and how much faster do the leaves around the body of our first father and mother fade. If they were determined to keep themselves covered, then they had to keep plundering nature and ply culture. They degraded themselves from king over all creation to the first sewing circle, and they had to keep busy in their job of tailoring for self-covering. There is a marvelous evolution in man's auto-soterism, self-saving, for he commenced with leaves and culminates with the cover of the hills and mountains, Revelations 6:16 and the latter is even more unsuccessful than the former.

God has in Christ a perfect covering. His blood is called the blood of covering, and of those who are covered with His righteousness are sheltered well for time and eternity. Of those justified and sheltered by His blood we read with a faint allusion to Adam's tailoring: "His leaf, "aleh," shall not wither." Psalms 1:3 "Whose leaf, "aleh" shall not fade." Ezekiel 47:12. God can use leaves for noble ends. At the end of history He shall use them for medicine for the bleeding nations of the Great Tribulation, Ezekiel 47:12; Revelations 22:2.

Meanwhile the dress-problem has been for man until our day a pressing problem. In Paradise this problem was unknown. When Israel was in the desert, this problem did not vex the mind, for during all the "trek" through the desert the garments did not become threadbare. The God of Paradise was to Israel the God of the desert; but Joseph and Achan were not the only ones who got into trouble through clothes. Japan and other nations have in our day done what the soldiers did with the seamless garment of Christ, they have each taken a part of Christian civilization, but without Him, and it has made them dangerous in the highest degree.

ORIGIN OF BLOODY SACRIFICES-Genesis 3:21

Higher critics say these are of man's invention, but this word says different. How could the bloody sacrifices ever be of man's invention? Adam did not start with them, but God did by clothing fallen man in a covering derived from death and the shed blood. It was by faith that Able offered unto God blood, and faith cometh by hearing. Without faith it is impossible to please God, Hebrews 11:4-5. Cain was of the devil and he came without blood. We know that God instituted blood sacrifices. From Genesis 3:21 we know that God clothed fallen man with coats of skin. This was an act of mercy revealing to him to cover not only his shame, but to combat also his suffering as the result of sin and protect man against every harm and fear and discomfort. Moreover, in this divine act lay clearly a symbolical meaning. It pointed to the necessity of the death of a substitute. That God killed the animal to clothe man may reasonably be accepted. God caused the death of an innocent creature to cover the sinful couple. Who does not here see Calvary?

AND HE SET UP THE TABERNACLE-Genesis 3:24

The verb "shakan," translated "and he placed," should be rendered as the title states and as it has been so translated in Joshua 18:1, where the same verb is given its right meaning: "And set up the tabernacle." When we thus translate this word with many moderns, then many things became a bit more understandable in the fourth chapter.

Then we can understand how the two brothers could bring an offering *unto the Lord*. The Lord had a tabernacle at the East of the Garden of Eden.

Then we see how the boys could so easily know that the Lord had respect to one and no respect to the other offering. Then we grasp why not a word is here said of the Lord's coming down to them, for He dwelt or tabernacled in the immediate vicinity.

Then we know that Cain could *go out from the presence of the Lord*, verse 16. The late Dr. Van Osdell of Grand Rapids was an excellent Bible teacher, and he gave this interpretation, and on that account called the whole antediluvian age the Cherubic Age.

SO HE DROVE OUT THE MAN-Genesis 3:24

The verb used here is *garash*, meaning to drive out with force. Jonah, used this verb when he said: "I am cast out of thy sight," Jon. 2:4. It is used for the driving out of the Canaanites from the land, Exodus 23:28, 31. Hagar was cast out, Genesis 21:10. Jephthah was thrust out by his selfrighteous brothers, Jud. 11:2, 7. It is a noteworthy fact that this verb came to us via the French in the name of garage with identically the same sound and sense. God used the first *garage* at Eden to drive out man. But this was a one way garage only. Man does not believe this. He actually thinks after 6000 years that this is a garage to drive out and in, for by means of the filthy rags of good works he wants to drive back into Paradise.

THE CHERUBIM-Genesis 3:24

The etymology of this word has been often a subject of study, and several theories have sprung up, but there is as yet no consensus of opinion among scholars, and we may perhaps safely conclude that this will remain an unsolved riddle.

We find them first mysteriously after the Fall East of the garden of Eden. God used them in judgment to drive man away from the tree of life. This very thought may be the key in regard to the task of these celestial beings. On the ark they were placed as a symbol of the holy watchman to ward off the men that dare approach God without blood. The Philistines and the men of Beth Shemesh have found this out with the bitterest experience. Seventeen times in Exodus alone they are named in connection with the ark. In all they appear about ninety times. A minute description is again given of them in I Kings 6 in connection with Solomon's temple.

Seven times we read that God sits or dwells between the Cherubims, I Samuel 4:4; II Samuel 6:2; II Kings 19:15; I Chronicles 13:6; Psalms 80:1-2; 99:1; Isaiah 37:16. Ezekiel describes them most elaborately not less than thirty-one times. In the tenth chapter he portrays them as God's messengers of judgment, that pull the judgment chariot of the supreme judge. He calls them also the living beings, which John in Revelations has translated with the word "zoa," which also means "living beings." In the judgment songs of I Samuel 22:11 and in Psalms 18:10-11 we also read that the coming judge rode upon a Cherub. All in all we must confess that they are most mysterious beings. They have some characteristics of an angel, some of man, some of a lion, some of an ox, and some of an eagle. Their bodies and activities are radically different from those of men. It is really a comfort to know that we soon shall know them.

They must be carefully distinguished from the "Seraphim," which comes from the verb "saraph," "to burn," "to be on fire." The idea is evidently that they blaze with the holiness of God. As much as we read of the cherubim, so little we read of the seraphim. In fact Isaiah 6:2-6 is the only place that speaks of them. These are also most mysterious celestial far removed from us, who have been made in God's image. They have and use three pairs of wings but they at the same time bear a general resemblance to man, because they have a face, a voice, feet and hands. According to Jewish scholars they stand at the head of nine choirs of angelic beings. They do not, like the cherubim, pull the throne wagon, but they hover above it and shout antiphonally about the holiness of the coming Christ, while they burn and dazzle with the holiness that shines on them from the holy God.

ABEL, A TYPE OF CHRIST-Genesis 4:8

1.-In is name meaning sorrow, suffering, vanity. Christ was a man of sorrows in His first appearing.

2.-In his being hated by his own brother. Christ was hated by his brothers according to the flesh, Israel.

3.-In his being killed by his brother. Christ was killed by his brother-nation.

4.-In his great faith, righteousness and obedience, which Christ all had in perfection.

5.-In that he speaks after he is dead, the resurrection.

6.-In that his blood is speaking and is compared to the blood of Christ.

7.-In that he ranks first in the picture gallery of Hebrews 11.

CAIN AND ABEL-Genesis 4:1-16

In the protevangelium God spoke of two kinds of seed. Here they are at the very gates of Eden. Cain was "of that wicked one." Abel was the man of faith who speaks after he is dead. He understood that man can only be accepted of God on the ground of sacrifice. Faith works by love, but sin works hate, I John 3:12. Eve expected her first born to be Jehovah, the

promised. Abel was the first shepherd and his occupation is the first mentioned in the Bible of those born of women; though the younger than Cain, his work is mentioned before that of Cain. Even here God took away the first to establish the second. Abel was slain; the good shepherd was slain, because he was righteous, I John 3:12. Three times he is called *just* in the New Testament, Matthew 23:25; Hebrews 11:4; I John 3.12-13; Com. Luke 23:47; Acts 3:14. The sacrifice of this good shepherd referred to Christ. Abel's faith was from hearing the Word of God about the Redeemer. He brought God the first, and it was a bloody substitutionary offering. Like Christ he was hated without a cause. Just as he speaks after his death so our Savior does, Hebrews 12:24.

The brothers were of the same blood and training but faith made all the difference. The first baby to be born into this fallen world became through unbelief a fratricide. Abel was born in sin as well as Cain, but he believed and obeyed God. God counted his faith for righteousness, as He later did with Abraham and David, Romans 4:3-6 and all who believe on the same ground 4:24. God accepted him and his offering, while he rejected the far nicer show of Cain. We too are justified by blood, Romans 5:9. Shed blood was always and still is today the only fresh and living toward God and heaven. Abel was the first man to die, and he was the first martyr, "because his deeds were righteous." Abel still speaks of the precious blood, of faith, and justification by faith.

CAIN BROUGHT OF THE FRUIT-Genesis 4:3

We see here almost on the first page of Holy Writ that self-willed religion is a deadly and God-dishonoring thing. It clothed our first parents with fig leaf aprons; it murdered the first brother ever born, it defiantly built the tower of Babel, killed the Prophets, persecuted the Apostles, crucified Christ. It tried to exterminate the young Church in ten great persecutions and drove her into the weird Catacombs of Rome. It originated the lifeless Oriental Churches, it caused the terrible Crusades and made the blood of the martyrs flow in streams. Inherently Cain denied the fundamental difference between God and man, the fall and the sentence of Death, the curse and the promise with the offering provided by God's grace. He basically denied Christ and Calvary. Cain's way is the way of brutal self-will in religion, the way of apostasy from God, the way of hate and indifference to a brother, the way of disobedience and rebellion, a way of wandering, meandering and work, a way of Godless culture and civilization, a way of despair, of death and doom. It was the bloodless way that all too soon became the bloody way. We see the same thing happen to the nations in our day. Refusing the blood of the Lamb, they follow the bloody beasts.

CAIN OF THAT WICKED ONE

What does John mean when he says that Cain was of the wicked one? The Spirit means to bring out the idea that Cain was not only an ugly fratricide, but a tool of Satan to make an immediate and deadly attack upon the promised seed of the woman, but as usual, Satan overshot the mark for God made the death of Abel a wonderful picture of Calvary and gave Seth as a picture of the risen Savior, Genesis 4:25 who became a father of a holy seed after

the cruel death of the innocent one. Seth and his seed remained in the proximity of Paradise, as if to be nearer to God than the Cainites.

How could Cain as one man build a city?

He did not build a London or Paris or New York, or Baalbec, but a row of houses and it is not said that he did this singlehanded. In building a city he forsook nature for culture. First he tried to please and appease God with nature, when God was not pleased with this bloodless naturalism, he tried culture behind the walls. It is a significant statement when we read that Cain was "going out from the presence of Jehovah" Genesis 4:16. In the wild life and the night life of the city he tried to use the voice of music to drown out the voice of a guilty conscience. Godlessness kept pace with culture and progress in the fine arts.

WHAT WAS THE REAL DIFFERENCE BETWEEN CAIN AND ABEL?-Genesis 4

No difference at all apart from the grace of God.

Both were corrupt branches of a bad tree.

Both were born from sinful parents outside of Paradise.

Both were guilty sinners coming short of the glory of God.

Both were under the sentence of death.

Both were equally religious and proved this by their sacrifices.

Both had the promise of a Redeemer.

For the rest it is all dissimilarity of faith and unfaith. Cain took refuge in nature, Abel in Scripture, or the Word of the Lord. Cain's bloodless way became soon the bloody way. We see this today also. The nations that have trampled upon the blood are gravitating with Cain to the most bloody fratricidal strife. Cain was an unbeliever, Abel a believer. Cain was a rationalistic modernist, Abel a fundamentalist. Cain had a fine show in line with the human heart that loves fairs and exhibitions, whereas the killing of a little lamb by Abel seemed to be cruel and offensive. The offense of the cross was even there and also the fair show to escape the offense of the cross of Galatians 6. Cain brought God a bouquet while Abel brought the sacrifice of a lamb and a broken heart which God will never despise. Why, it is asked, is the Bible so harsh on Cain seeing that many believers today have his watchword: Am I my brother's keeper?

All that Cain did was wrong and pointed to a perverse will and a rebellious heart filled with enmity against God.

He worships in Satanic self-will against God's order.

He is consumed with hatred. His countenance fell. The fallen fell still deeper.

He is angry with God.

He refuses to bring a sin-offering.

He kills his own brother.

He lies to God.

He becomes a vagabond and goes out from the presence of God.

THE WAY OF CAIN

It was the way of unbelief in God, His Word and His curse.

It was the way of self-will.

It was the way of determined apostasy.

It was the way of blatant denial of all truth.

It was the way of stubborn disobedience, rebellion.

It was the way of a double curse.

It was the way of open defiance.

It was the way of soul-suicide.

It was the way of fratricide.

It was the way of the greatest folly.

It was the way of despair.

It was the way of doom.

It was the bloodless and yet the bloody way.

ABEL, OR VANITY AND VEXATION OF SPIRIT - Genesis 4:2

The word "vanity," "hebel" is used thirty-nine times in Ecclesiastes. We know the word yet as the proper name "Abel." It means "hollow," "empty," "worthless." Solomon had wine and women, wealth and wantonness, water and the world at its best, but he gave a crushing condemnation of the whole thing. No, God did it through Solomon, in order that no reader of this book might ever fall in love with this vain and fleeting world.

This word reflects interestingly Eve's disappointment in regard to Cain from whom she at first had such exalted expectations. According to the Hebrew she evidently thought that He was Jehovah, the promised Deliverer, but she must have soon found out that he was of the evil one, and when her second son was born, her disappointment was reflected in the name given to him.

When the Apostle of love analyzed the contents and ingredients of the whole cosmos his description fully harmonizes with this word of the wise Solomon. The lust of the eyes is vanity, the lust of the flesh likewise and the pride is vainglory also.

CAIN'S OFFERING-Genesis 4:5

We err if we make the tithes something legalistic and Jewish because Abraham and Jacob paid tithes centuries before the law was ever given, Genesis 14:20; 28:22; Heb. 7:2, 6. There were three kinds of tithes: 1. One tenth of all the product of the soil was assigned for the support of the Levites. 2. The Levites in turn had to pay of their share to the support of the High Priest. 3. The third tithe was applied to the expense of the great festivals.

This was specifically Jewish, but the idea of giving a tenth part of one's blessings to God was not legalistic and Israelitish because it was found far before the Mosaic law was ever given. The rejection of Cain's offering was by some early writers connected with the tithing. Tertullian in the third century claimed that God rejected Cain's offering because Cain did not rightly divide his sacrifice. The Septuagint version runs here as follows: "If thou didst rightly offer, but didst not rightly divide, didst thou not sin? Hold thy peace." The Septuagint was made 280 years before Christ from a Hebrew copy which must have been far more than a thousand years older than the oldest Hebrew manuscript we now possess. It was this version which Christ and the Apostles nearly always used. The Greek in Hebrews 11:4 reads significantly "pleiona thusian", i.e. "a more abundant sacrifice than Cain." Abel offered by faith and this is ever wrapt up with obedience. God must have revealed the law of the tithes to them. Then it would be perfectly understandable and even natural, that the patriarchs, Abraham and Jacob and no doubt the others, knew about the law of the tithes.

RELATIVES IN THE BIBLE-Genesis 4:9

The family relations got off in a bad start with *Cain and Abel. Koreh* was a cousin of Moses, and his rebellion originated in a family quarrel and family envy, which proved often so implacable and destructive. *Amram* married his aunt Jocebed. Weak children are often the result of consanguinity in marriage, but from this marriage came at least three geniuses: Moses, Aaron, and Miriam. In Exodus 6:20 it is expressly stated that Jochebed was the sister of Amram's father. Consequently she married her nephew who had to call her his aunt. Such marriages were later forbidden by law, and several attempts have been made to eliminate this unsavory fact from Moses' parentage and to prove a more distant relationship, but every attempt has proven futile. It is best to remember that when this marriage of Moses' parents was contracted, there was as yet no law given against such consanguity in marriage. As Kitto says: "The written knowledge that they were subsequently interdicted, sufficiently accounts for this one being so pointedly mentioned". All the antediluvians were blood relatives who could easily figure out their pedigree. The more than two billion inhabitants on this globe today are all still blood relatives of old Adam and they show all the traits and tricks of old Adam.

NOD-Genesis 4:16

Cain went and dwelt in the land of Nod. What "Nod" means we can easily find out when we look up the original of Psalm 56:8, where David says: "Thou tellest my *wanderings,"* and this word is *Nod.* God did not make man to wander as a sheep in the desert nor as a lambkin in the wilderness. This *Nod* was the result of several things:

It was the result of a bloodless religion. He tried to please God without Blood.

It was the result of wrath that God did not respect and accept his bloodless offering.

It was the result of rejecting God's pleadings and warnings still to go and take the sin offering that lay as a lamb at the door.

It was the result of his bloody way with his brother. The bloodless way leads to the bloody way as we can see in our day. We see here also that when man is out of God's way, then he falls out with his brother and is ready to commit the gruesome sin of fratricide. After Israel left the shepherd, every sheep of the flock went his own way, Isaiah 53:6.

Those who refuse to keep God's Word, refuse to keep their brother, even if they do not proudly say to God: "Am I my brother's keeper?" After this crying sin God cursed him with at least an earthly curse, predicting that he would be a fugitive and vagabond in the earth.

Then a dark despair settled down upon his soul and uttered itself in the sad wail: "My punishment is greater than I can bear. Everyone that findeth me shall slay me."

And thereupon with the mark of the letter *Tau,* the last letter of the Hebrew alphabet, which according to some had the shape of the ancient cross, upon him, he set out from the face and tabernacle of the Lord and his sad *Nod* commenced.

JUBAL-Genesis 4:21

This man's name has a remarkable history. He became the father of all that handle the harp and organ. According to Josephus this descendant of Cain "cultivated music, and invented the psaltery and cithara," a sort of harp. The word "juabal" means "a stream" or "a blast on a ram's horn," "a stream of sound." "A long blast with the jobel," Joshua 6:4-5 here five times rendered *ram's horn.* In Leviticus 25 this word is used fourteen times for the year of jubile and in chapter 27 five times more. This Cainite's name then became synonymous with music, song and rejoicing. The Apostate's have lost the music of God's paradise, and they are most efficient to make their own blasts of merriment. But God has used this name of this apostate for His own divine joy, a prophecy that some day all earthly joy shall be swallowed up in His great jubilee of jubilees, the millennium. And since this word came also to mean the trumpet made of a ram's horn, God connected nicely the typical blood of Calvary with it. Where sin abounds, grace doth much more abound.

BIBLE MUSIC-Genesis 4:21

Here in the early part of Genesis we find that music is one of the most ancient arts of man. The harp and the organ or flute as some translate were the first instruments invented. Some of the first wind instruments were made of the horns of animals and even later when made of metals, they must have kept their original shape of horns as our horns generally do. The *keren,* horn is used in Joshua 6:7; Daniel 3:5, 7, 10, 15. In Daniel it is translated cornet which means little horn. The *shophar* or *trumpet* was larger and less curved shape.

We see man loves music since time immemorial. He has always used and abused it. He has not used its sweet strains to glorify his Maker, but he has rather made it subservient to his own ends, to forget the earnestness of life, to drown the memory of lost Paradise, and to destroy his responsibility and accountability to God.

LAMECH I-Genesis 4:23

He was not the first polygamist, but the first bigamist for he had only two wives: Adah and Zillah. Genesis writes the beginnings of many things, and also of the first war poet and war poetry. He was also a dangerous killer and braggart who sang with bravado about his own deviltry. Nevertheless his war song has a formal beauty for it has rhythm, parallelism, harmony and elevated diction, all in the line of the artistic development of Cain's lineage. In this song he glorifies murder and bigamy and hatred, whilst he flatly denies punishment. He thinks he can get away with crime. God is not in all his reckoning. For the rest it is not exactly clear what he means to bring out. It is like most modern art, esthetic in form, rotten in contents. The Lord put this war song in His book to show the awful degeneracy in the unholy line of Cain. Apostasy always leads to insolence toward God and man. It is a remarkable fact that Lamech's three sons were all inventors. The inventions came in the wicked line of Cain as it is today. What was the line of Seth? Ten patriarchs from Adam to Noah are reported: Adam, Seth, Enoch, Kenan, Mahalalel, Jared, Enoch, Methusalah, Lamech, Noah. Over against the culture of Cain stands in vivid contrast the picture of Seth's holy lineage.

AND HE DIED-Genesis 5:5

Genesis 5 is the Old Testament grave yard. It is the cemetery of Adam's sinful brood. The wages of sin is death. The king of terrors swayed his black scepter undisputed for all the 1659 years of the antediluvian times. The strong giants who filled the earth with violence fell before this tyrant one after the other and perhaps sometimes together in battle. Eight times we read here the somber refrain: "He died" - 5, 8, 11, 14, 17, 20, 27, 31. All went the way of all flesh with but one notable and unique exception, startling, spectacular, sensational! One man escaped Adam's cemetery. The king of terrors could not mow him down with his sickle. No funeral was held for him, at least no interment was made. His body lay not in state, was not viewed by a morbid crowd, and was not laid to rest in the

general acre of the dead. Of Enoch we read not that he died, but that God took him. The morticians could do nothing for him, for here was no mortification, but translation, i.e., a glorious transportation from earth to heaven. Transportation from the midst of horrible degeneration of the antediluvian times.

Art is long and time is fleeting,

And our hearts, though stout and brave,

Still like muffled drums are beating

Funeral marches to the grave.

Thus sang the poetic Lamechs of that day, and they were right, but for this grand exception. God took one like this before the law, one from under the law, and one after the fulfilling of the law,-and soon we go.

ENOCH'S PREACHING-Genesis 5:21-24; Jude 14 Enoch the antediluvian preacher said, the Lord is come. This he preached over four thousand years ago, how is it that the Lord after all this time has not come?

This is called :he prophetic perfect by which the things of the future are presented as already happened. God uses this to give us to understand that the future is just as sure with God as the facts that have come to pass. His plan is just as certain as reality, the future just as sure as the past. In fact with God there is no future for He lives in the eternal present, and thousand years with Him as are one day and one day as a thousand years.

ENOCH'S TWO PROPHECIES:-Genesis 5:21-32

Jude 14, 15

The antediluvians lived to a grand old age. Adam lived 930 years, Seth 912, Enos 905, Cainan 910, Mahaleel 895, Jared 962, and Methuselah 969. Yet a thousand years in God's sight are but as a yesterday that is passed, Psalms 90:4.

They lived on a cursed earth and as a guilty generation under the penalty of death. In each case except that of Enoch we read "and he died". It is Satan's majority report. Earth was even then a cemetery and there was only one break in the antediluvian funeral train. Life was one constant fulfillment of Genesis 2:17 and Romans 5:12. A great miracle however showed that death was not an inevitable iron fate for His own. One man escaped the undertaker and the grave. While he walked with God, he worked for God and warned the ungodly of the coming judge as Jude shows.

But what was now his second prophecy? This is found in the long and important name he gave to his son Methuselah, meaning: "When he dies it shall come," meaning of course the flood as a judgment. The deluge came exactly on his death as is seen from the following facts: Methuselah was 187 years old at Lamech's birth, Lamech was 182 years old when Noah was born and the flood came when Noah was 600 years old. Adding up these figures we get exactly 969 years, the year of Methuselah's death and the year of the deluge. Why did this man get so old? The answer is that his life was so long drawn out

because of the longsuffering of our God which waited in the days of Noah, 1 Peter 3:20. Judging is called by Isaiah God's strange work, whereas the whole Bible is there to show that He delights in mercy. He waited over four centuries ere the sin of the Amorites was filled to the brim, Genesis 15:13-16; Leviticus 18:25, 20:23. All this was done in anticipation of the future deluge of fire. Coming things cast their shadows far ahead.

ENOCH WALKED WITH GOD-Genesis 5:22, 24

Twice we are assured that Enoch walked with God. He kept step with God, not vice versa.

What really does it mean that Enoch walked with God?

Spiritually, it presupposes his reconciliation to God.

It means his full surrender to God.

It means agreement with God. See Amos 3:3.

It means obedience to God. It means satisfaction in God.

It includes also the ideas of power, plan, purpose, purity, progress and avoidance of selfwill and self-chosen paths.

The object of Enoch's translation was a public reward for the patriarch's fidelity and a public warning for his ungodly contemporaries; it could remind of the immortal life in heaven while typically it reminds us of the Savior's ascension and our own sudden home-going at the time of the rapture. Israel divided the world's history in three parts of two thousand, before the law, under the law and after the law, we see that in each of these periods there was a rapture.

LAMECH II-Genesis 5:25

Cain's line was resourceful, inventive, and cultural. The first Lamech was a poet, paramour, and polygamist who sang a war song with rhythm, parallelism, and elevated diction. Culture flourished in Cain's Christless civilization, but this Lamech of the godly line of Seth is a sharp contrast and a perfect antidote to the former Lamech. The name is the only thing he holds in common with him. Cain's culture, organs, and harps, could not comfort his heart thirsting for the living God. He saw the curse all around him, deeply felt and lamented it, while he yearned for a deliverer from this dreadful thing. He let others sing of vengeance, war, and a false peace; nothing could heal his wounded, bleeding, yearning heart but God himself. A little one was expected in his family, and one happy day God gave him a son in his home. Oh, that this might be the promised Comforter! With prophetic hope he called the newborn Comforter, but he was mistaken as Mother Eve had been before him when she thought Cain was Jehovah. Nevertheless, blessed are those who are homesick and yearn for God's comfort and rest, for they shall get home.

NOAH THE PREACHER OF RIGHTEOUSNESS

Genesis 5:32

"Which sometimes were disobedient," says Peter 3:20. Both Christ and Peter stressed the disobedience of the Antediluvians.

How was it that Noah a preacher of righteousness for over a century did not have more fruit upon his labor?

Noah's preaching was rejected in unbelief and undoubtedly they had their reasons therefore. They must have sneered that in the more than a thousand years the world stood such a strange thing had never happened. They may have said as the scientists do today that there was not enough water for a general flood. They may have thought it crazy to build a big boat on dry land. They may also have claimed that if an inundation should occur that it would not be as bad as Noah said, and that they could always flee to the high table lands and the mountains. They may have argued scientifically against it, but they died in due time scientifically. The heaven-defying giants were drowned like rats. It is always better to listen to one real man of God than to a thousand skeptical scientists. At the same time there was great offence and folly in Noah's preaching to the natural heart. Only faith could enter into the ship when there was no cloud in heaven; to all the others it was fun and frolic and folly. The one man Noah made himself by faith the laughing stock of the world of his day. When God closed the ark behind him there was not even a cloud on the horizon, no token in the sky of the coming cataclysm, and that infidel hell-bent and hell-bound generation, no doubt, saw more cause for its thrills and its merry-making than ever before. The fun and feast lasted a week. Then the flood came and the ark was there but closed and hence useless for them. They had sinned away their day of grace. Let us remember the solemn warning of the Savior that *as* it was in the days of Noah *so* shall it be in the days of the Son of man. In these little words as and so lie a whole volume of exegesis and warning.

JAPHETH-Genesis 5:32

The Greeks claimed that they descended from an early ancestor by the name of *Japetos*. They spell the name in different ways, but it is evident, that he is no other ancestor than Japheth, the son of Noah. After him the Greeks in the Old Testament are called *Javans*. Hence ever since Alexander the Great who laid low the rotten Empires of the East, the Japhethites have ruled the world, for the Romans were also descendants of Japheth. Of course, the Europeans and Americans take for granted that this will always be so, but this is taking too much for granted. Even in our day it is evident that God stands ready to bring about in the near future most tremendous changes. Once the power and glory of the nations went Westward, but now the West is dying and the sleepy East has wakened for the funeral. Napoleon warned about the sleeping giant China, which would shake the world when awake. Well China has awakened in the stress and storm of all her miseries, and it has not awakened with love in her heart for the West, but with the most profound contempt; and although it is still weak and bleeding of a thousands wounds, it may soon arise as a Red power to shake the world.

FAVOR, CHEN-Genesis 6:8

This means "unmerited favor," "grace," and has been embodied in numerous proper nouns, including "Johan," grace of Jehovah, contracted to our "John." It is just as "chen," alone used sixty-seven times, the first time with Noah, when it says Genesis 6:8 "Noah found *chen,* grace." As early as Genesis it is found fourteen times. Some well meaning folk talk of grace today as if it were an altogether new thing, but we must not forget that it is at least over five thousand years old. Though Israel and the others on the other side of the cross did not live in the dispensation or economy of grace, yet there was abundant grace in all the various economies. All that man gets above the lake of fire is unmerited and forfeited grace. Ham in the ark could enjoy even in that early day what has been termed *common grace*.

ALL FLESH HAD CORRUPTED HIS WAY ON THE EARTH

Genesis 6:12

The word "flesh" is used 148 times in the New Testament, and 98 times of these in Paul's letters. Though used in at least five different senses, it is generally the reigning principle in every unsaved man. It does not improve by multiplication for what is born of the flesh is flesh. Flesh has no eugenics. It ever begets its kind and cannot soar to higher sphere. Even when man becomes a new creation, his flesh is thereby not improved as Romans 7 clearly evinces. Heavenly experience does not ameliorate it as we see in II Corinthians 12, where Paul needed after his trip to Paradise a thorn in the proud flesh, lest he get puffed up with pride. Having the Spirit does not improve the flesh, for the Spirit does not operate to improve it but to impugn and fight it, as we see in Galatians 5. Many fight the old man or the flesh, but God warned us that our fight is not against flesh and blood. We have no right to say "fight," where God says "faith." In faith we are to reckon the flesh or the old man to have been crucified and buried with Christ with that glorious baptism of His death. All flesh is as grass and mankind like Lot of old chooses the grass of Sodom while only here and there is an Abraham who takes grace above grass. The grass of nature withers, and mankind withers and is corrupt to the core. As we now see the world filled as in Noah's day, there are few that dare deny man's total depravity. Thank God the way to heaven cannot be corrupted.

THE EARTH WAS FILLED WITH VIOLENCE-Genesis 6:13

As it was in the day of Noah *so* shall it be in the day of the Son of man. We need not look for a future fulfillment of this word, though we may perhaps look for a more complete realization of this word than we have it today. Strictly speaking the statement of our Lord is full of comfort, for we know that the fulness of the violence will make place for another fulness, and that a fulness of glory, Numbers 14:21, where the same word: the verb "maleh" is used. And again in Isaiah 11:9 we have the same word: "The earth shall be *full* of the knowledge of His name." The earth is full of the goodness of God, Psalms 33:5. The earth is *full* of thy riches," Psalms 104:24. The earth, O Lord, is *full* of thy mercy, Psalms 119:64.

Christ in His coming shall make the earth *full* of His praise, Hab. 3:3 and then the earth shall also be *filled* with God's glory, Hab. 2:14. However, before all this blessed fulness of knowledge, praise, and glory comes, the earth will be filled with the most terrible judgments. The root "mal" of this word is the same as the Latin "mul" from which we get our multifarious, multiformity, multiple, multiplicity, multiply, multitude, multocular, multiplication, etc. All words which still have the Hebrew idea of fulness.

THE FATHER OF SUCH AS DWELL IN TENTS

Genesis 6:20, 21

The word "father" is used far more in the East than with us. The inventor or originator of anything is called "father" of the thing he originated. Jabal was father of tents and Jubal father of the harp and organ. A man with a very big nose is today called father of the nose; a man with a long heavy beard, father of the beard. A chief was called father of the ostrich because his swift horse could run down an ostrich. A negro killed two lions, from that day on the Arabs called him *Abu Sebaim* father of the lions. In Egypt the kite, a bird, is called father of the air. Because the coming Christ will rule the next age and eternity, He is called the everlasting father. Lies originated with the devil, hence he is called the father of lies, John 8:44. Circumcision as a commanded ordinance commenced with Abraham, hence he is said to be the father of circumcision, Romans 4:12. God is called the Father of mercies, II Corinthians 1:3 and in Ephesians 1:17 the Father of glory. There is a corresponding use of the word children.

THE LIGHT THE ANTEDILUVIANS HAD-Genesis 6

They had the light of nature, Romans 1:19.

They had a very pure and reliable tradition. Their fathers knew Adam.

They had the light of the promise of the woman's seed. That this was understood is apparent from both Eve and Lamech's mistake.

They had the light of a strong and clear intellect.

They had the light of nearly two millenniums of experience. They had the light of solemn warnings as given by faithful men like Abel, Enoch, Lamech, and Noah.

They had the light of Enoch's translation.

They had the light of the sacrificial blood from God's example and Abel's sacrifice.

They had the light of the miraculous mark on Cain and God's warnings to him.

They had the light of the flaming cherubs which seem to have dwelt on earth during that whole age of sixteen and a half centuries.

They had the light of Enoch's prophecy about the Lord's coming with all His saints and they had the light of his mysterious rapture and of the searching parties that came home without Enoch.

They had the light of the ark that was long in building. By this ark he condemned them.

They had the light of Noah's faithful preaching and warning. Rejection of all this light caused the lightning bolts of judgment to strike. This rejection of God's light was the real cause of the flood.

THE THREE ARKS-Genesis 7

Noah's ark is called "tebah," chest. The big vessel was regarded as a big chest, a large box, adrift upon the waters.

The ark of the bulrushes Exodus 2:3 in which Moses was laid adrift in the Nile has the same name as the above, "tebah." The babe was, of course, put in a small chest, regarded as a little ship.

The *Ark of the Covenant* bears an altogether different name. That is called an "aron," first translated "coffin," in which Joseph's body was put. This is the common name for "chest," "coffer," "coffin," "box." The word is used over a hundred and fifty times.

The first ark bore the seed of the woman and in Ham also the seed of the serpent. Did God not let an opportunity slip, when He did not let destroy the seed of the serpent? No. When this was once there, He wanted a struggle of millenniums between these two.

The second ark bore the Old Testament deliverer of the seed of the woman, while the last one prophetically and typically bore the crucified and risen Savior.

NOAH-Genesis 7

This name comes from the verb "noach" meaning "to rest from weary toil, travel, or strife." The verb appears about eighty times.

The ark rested, "noach," in the seventh month, Genesis 8:4.

God rested "noach," in the seventh day, Exodus 20:11.

When the ark rested, "noach," Numbers 10:36.

The Spirit rested, "noach," on the 70 elders, Numbers 11:25.

The spirit rested, "noach," upon Eldad and Medad, Numbers 11:26.

That thy manservant may rest, "noach," Deuteronomy 5:14.

God would give Israel rest, "noach," after all the wandering through the wilderness, Exodus 33:14; Deuteronomy 12:10; Joshua 21:44; 22:4; 23:1; II Samuel 7:1, 11; I Kings 5:4, 18; I Chronicles 22:9, 18; 23:25; II Chronicles 14:6; Deuteronomy 25:19.

The Spirit of Jehovah was to rest, "noach," upon the Messiah, Isaiah 11:2.

After Satan's overthrow the whole world will be "at rest" "noach," Isaiah 14:7.

Israel was never to forget that God gave them "noach," Nehemiah 9:28.

The stay in the land after the many years in Egypt and in the desert is called the rest, "noach," II Chronicles 14:6, 7; 15:15; 20:30.

Wisdom "noach" in the heart of him that has understanding, Proverbs 14:33; whereas anger "noach" in the bosom of fools, Ecclesiastes 7:9.

In the midst of all his trouble poor job was looking for "noach," rest. He envied those in the grave because they had rest, "noach," Job 3:13,17.

Daniel was promised "noach," rest after his long and difficult life, Daniel 12:13, at the pagan court.

Habakuk was looking forward for "noach," rest, in the day of trouble, 3:16.

Ezekiel was set to "noach," rest, in the midst of the valley of dry bones, 37:1. Later he was set, "noach," upon a high mountain, 40:2.

Jeremiah lamented: "We labor and have no "noach," rest." Lamentations 5:5.

The Jews in Esther's day had "noach," rest from their foes, 9:16, 17, 18, 22.

It is plain from these few examples that this word denotes the comfort of rest such as comes after weariness or toil, travel, and strife.

When Lamech the son of Methuselah and father of Noah named his son, Noah, he thought of such a rest saying: "This same shall comfort us concerning our work and toil of our hands, because of the ground which the Lord hath cursed." Noah became a great preacher of righteousness but he was not able to give to weary mankind the longed for rest from the curse. He became the head of a new world and had, next to Adam in Paradise, the best start any man ever had, but he also alas took a wrong rest, in a wrong time, a wrong way, and a wrong place. The one upon whom the Spirit of the Lord rests, "noach," and who shall give the whole earth "noach," rest, is the only One that can give an enduring rest to all mankind from the weary toil and strife that sin and satan brought upon man. His name *is Jesus,* the *Shiloh,* the rest-giver. He has said: "Come unto me, and I will give you rest."

THE FOUR NEW ORDINANCES CONNECTED WITH THE NOAHIC CONVENANT

Genesis 8, 9

1.-The fear and dread of man is laid upon every beast of the earth. This was therefore evidently not the case before the flood. This makes the miracle of the wild beasts coming to Noah without harming him all the greater. This was for man's protection and a prevention of general defeat of man by beasts. Yet in pagan lands thousands are annually killed by wild beasts and serpents.

2.-The flesh of animals is given for food. Evidently the world had been vegetarian for 1656 years. If they ate meat, they did it without permission of the Lord. Flesh eaters now have a special grant from God. Vegetarianism has now no leg to stand on.

3.-The flesh allowed, the blood was prohibited. Later, in Leviticus 17: 10, 11 God gave three reasons for this interdiction: (a). The life of the flesh is in the blood; (b). The blood was

to be used upon the altar, to make atonement; (c). Seeing that the animal blood could not take away sin, it is a picture of Calvary's blood that did take away sin.

4.-Capital punishment is introduced. Cain and Lamech were not put to death for their murder. Lack of law seems to have been one of the reasons why the earth was so filled with violence. From now on until God shall be all and in all, the irrevocable rule holds: "whoso sheddeth man's blood, by man shall his blood be shed." From Romans 13:1-5 we know that God today does not want blood avengers, but that He has given the sword of justice to the state to execute the divine penalty upon the killers, Genesis 9:6. When Peter drew the sword to kill Malchus the Lord Jesus reminded him of this divine ordinance given to Noah. For a Biblical christian these facts settle the question of capital punishment. It is just as scriptural as holy wedlock. It is also most merciful both for the killer and for the whole society. The killers in their fear for death often cry for mercy and not so seldom are saved, if presented with the gospel of grace, whereas if they linger in prison they as a rule grow harder and harder. The reason why man may not be murdered lies in the fact as stated in Genesis 9:6 that he is the image of God. This deep and glorious truth is denied by Evolutionism. In Romans 9:4, 5 Paul teaches that the covenants belong to Israel when he says of his kinsmen according to the flesh "whose are ... the covenants." Was this also true of the Noahic covenant? Yes, this covenant had Israel in mind and was preparatory to Israel. If God would again destroy all the wicked as in the flood, He could not have an *am olam*, an everlasting and indestructible people like Israel upon the earth. Then note well that this covenant for the perpetuity of nature and the continuity of the human race was not made alone with Noah, but also with his seed, and we know that Israel descended from Shem. Hatred against Israel is even now called Antisemitism.

THE MOUNTAINS OF THE BIBLE-Genesis 8:4

The East on the whole is very mountainous. God spoke to Israel generally in mountains or in deserts.

Ararat, Genesis 8:4, the place where Noah's ark rested.

Abarim, Balaam's blessings.

Bashan, Og's home; famed for oaks and cattle.

Carmel, I King's 18:19, Elijah's sacrifice.

Ebal, Deuteronomy 27:4, the curse for law breakers.

Gerizim, John 4:20. The blessing for the law keepers.

Gilboa, I Samuel 31:8. Scene of Saul's death.

Gilead, Genesis 31:48. Scene of covenant between Jacob and Laban.

Hermon, Deuteronomy 4:48. Conjectured site of transfiguration.

Hor, Numbers 20: 27, 28. Now called Jebel Haroun, Mount of Aaron.

Horeb, Exodus 3:1. Scene of burning bush.

Lebanon, II Chronicles 2:8-10. Source of timber for Solomon's temple.

Moriah, II Chronicles 2:8-10. Place of Isaac's sacrifice and temple hill.

Nebo, Deuteronomy 34:1. Place of Moses' death.

Olivet, II Samuel 15:30. Scene of David's flight from Absolom and of Christ's three-fold weeping.

Seir, Genesis 32:3; 36:8. Mountain range of Edom.

Sinai, Exodus 19:1-11. Scene of law-giving.

Tabor, Mk. 9:2. Probable scene of transfiguration.

Zion, II Samuel *5:7.* Stronghold of Jebusites.

SIN IN THE NEW WORLD-Genesis 9:21

Noah's privileges had been exceptionally great.

He had walked with God like Enoch.

He had heard God's voice clearly and repeatedly.

He had seen God's wondrous works of judgment and of mercy.

He had enjoyed God's deliverance and keeping power.

He had tasted special mercy in his family. God had taken even the impure Ham in the ark.

He had undoubtedly tasted the joy of praying for his sinful race. He had been set apart as a preacher of righteousness.

Though preaching evidently for 120 years without a convert, God had honored the word of his warning by bringing it to pass.

He had tasted the joy of the bloody burnt offerings and their smelling as a sweet savor by Jehovah.

He had experienced the joy of receiving many promises and ordinances from God.

After all these privileges what do we see? He dismally fell and became a drunken sot and nudist, being mocked by his own lustful son. In the flesh never dwells a good thing.

There is a great parallel between Adam and Noah.

Both were most highly privileged.

Both stood at the head of a new world.

Both had to be fruitful and multiply.

Both dismally fell, the one by eating, the other by drinking.

THEY COVERED THE NAKEDNESS OF THEIR FATHER

Genesis 9:22, 23

Ever since Adam sinned and was ashamed of his nakedness, the Word of God has manifested everywhere a real horror of nudism, "arvah." It sometimes stands for an unclean thing, Deuteronomy 23:14. The word here is "arvah" nakedness. It also stands for shame, for the shame of Egypt is really the nakedness of Egypt, Isa. 20:4. In Leviticus 18 this word "arvah" appears not less than twenty-two times, and this chapter clearly evinces that the shame of nudeness mainly has to do with the procreative organs. Man's clothes are not only a necessity, but a constant reminder of the sin and shame of his rebellion against God. When Elijah went up, the old mantle dropped to the earth. When we are by and by snatched by the rapture, then we shall leave our garments behind. They are needed only for earth the same as wedlock. Christ was made naked in order that He might cover our shame and nakedness before God with the mantle of righteousness.

It is an amazing fact that the one vile deed of Ham entailed such an awful curse on all his offspring, and that the one good deed of his brothers brought such innumerable blessings to the Shemites and the Japhethites. To the mind of unregenerate man this is all thoroughly offensive, but to the mind brought in subjection to His majestic will, it is awe-inspiring.

HAMABDIL, OR GOD'S DIVIDING-Genesis 10

1.-In Peleg's day he divided the *continents*. The Mediterranean broke through by the Rock of Gibraltar and Morocco, dividing Africa from Europe. The Atlantic separated the Americas from Europe. Australia was separated from Asia and the polar oceans separated the polar regions from Europe and Asia. At that time Atlantis undoubtedly sank below the Atlantic.

2.-The tongues were divided. So far Hebrew seems to have been the original language. The proper names of the antediluvians are Hebrew. Adam is red clay. Eve is living. Cain is acquisition. Abel is sorrow, mourning, vanity. Seth is substituted.

This language was perpetuated in Shem and Israel so that it is, like the Jew, with us today. But the one language was broken up in many tongues and derivatives at the Babylonian confusion of tongues. This separation was another judgment but mixed with mercy and in favor of the promised plan concerning the seed of the woman. As a curse it was and is terrible. If the Germans and the French and English spoke the same language, they might love one another, now they misunderstand and often hate one another. The different languages are a terrible barrier for peace and for the propagation of the gospel. What a time and trouble the heralds of the gospel have to spread the glad news. Nevertheless the tongue confusion was also a blessing. Babel's tower was the first Satanic attempt to unite all mankind in a universal empire against God's Word and plan. This Satanic united opposition to the promised seed was now broken.

3.-The third great division God made was the breaking up of the longevity of man. As to length of life, life was nearly decimated, i.e. decreased tenfold.

Noah became 950 years.

Abraham became 170 years.

Moses only 120 years.

David only 70 years.

This was an act of grace for the older man gets the more wicked he becomes. Old age is no deterrent to sin and incentive to holiness as the ancient giants before the deluge go to show, but it has proved a great preventative for filling the earth with violence. It is indeed a remarkable fact that now that man lives five times as fast and intensive as his grandfather, due to the modern inventions, we find that also now the earth is again filled with violence.

4.-The fourth great division was between the Jew and the Gentile. As the world got again in line with Satan, making uniformists instead of unity and holiness, God gave judicially the nations up as we read in the first chapter of Romans. We see there also why He gave them up. It was because they had completely and willfully forgotten Him and had abandoned themselves to the most unspeakable vileness, glorifying the creature above the Creator. Not in all, but in one nation was henceforth to be perpetuated His Word and will, His plan and promised seed. We see here also that God did not divide for the sake of division but for the sake of holiness. Israel was to be separate from the nations unto Him. The call of Abram was one of the great epochs of the world's history.

MAGOG, OR THE CAUCASUS-Genesis 10:2

In the two world wars we have often heard of this stupendous mountain range which separates south eastern Europe from Asia. The erudite Bochert claims that the Caucasus derived its name from the Hebrew *Gog-chasan,* signifying Gog's fort. We know from Genesis 10 that Magog, one of the *Noachidae,* went to that region; the Greeks made of Gog's fort the name Caucasus.

At the time there were four great divisions wrought by God:

1.-At the time of Peleg the earth was divided into continents. The Mediterranean then split Europe from Ophir, Africa, while the sinking of the Atlantis split Europe from America.

2.-The one Hebrew tongue split wide open into many strange languages, as it is today.

3.-The personal life was divided in that the longevity of centuries was taken away so that the Patriarchs were extremely old when one hundred years.

4.-Finally, the nations were divided in Jew and Gentile by the call of Abram. Then happened what we read as a somber refrain in Romans 1: "He gave them up."

PELEG-Genesis 10:25

The parents gave their son this name because at that time the earth was divided into continents. Europe was split from Africa by the Mediterranean and South America was broken away from Africa by the South Atlantic. If you take a globe one glance can tell you that South America has fit into Africa's West coast, and Europe fit into Africa's north coast. Not only there but the whole earth was broken and divided into continents. The big game remained in Africa although the mammoth elephants were once found as far north as Siberia.

Rivers also divide lands and nations and hence one of the names given by the Hebrews to these dividing streams was *Peleg, divider,* which occurs in ten passages: Job 29:6; Psalms 1:3; 46:4; 65:9, 10; 119:136; Proverbs 5:16; 21:1; Isaiah 30:35; 32:2; Lamentations 3:48. This word entered into Greek and Latin and by way of these languages we have now "pelagic," "Archipelago," "pelagian," "pelagianism," "semi-pelagianism." "Pelagian" in general means pertaining to the sea or river, but theologically this name came from the English monk Pelagius who denied all original sin and taught the innate rectitude of human nature. Pelagius means a man living by the sea or some separating stream.

THE SHEMITES-Genesis 10:21-32

The principal peoples descended from Shem were the Hebrews, Persians, Assyrians, and the principal Arabian tribes.

Elam is the ancient name for Persia, who joined with the Medians against the Babylonians.

Asshur denotes the country of Assyria.

Arphaxad points to the northern part of Assyria.

Lud refers to a tribe that settled in Asia Minor.

Aram is the Bible name for Syria, Numbers 23:7.

Here are some names as Salah and Peleg which must be taken as heads of tribes or nations.

Eber or Heber, whence sprung the Hebrew nation, that had the "Shem," the "name," in it, and hence the last is by far the most important of them all because the Redeemer sprang from this nation. It is mainly through Him that the Japhethites have exerted such a predominating influence upon the world for the last two thousand years. The rejection of Him removes this Japhetic influence. This great effect made itself felt in the superior culture of the white races over against the colored races. When we remember that there are not even a half billion whites in the world and over one billion and a half colored races who now daily come more unto their own rights, then we can see how this last war weakened mainly the Japhethite races. According to Ezekiel 38 and 39 the Japhethites under the lead of *Rosh,* Russia, will,

heave themselves to one mighty onslaught against Shem in the Holy Land, but that will become the end of the Japhethic superiority.

THE DESIGN OF BABEL-Genesis 11:4

It is a childlike notion to think that the design of this towel was to get to heaven. True we read of a "tower whose top may reach unto heaven," but that is the Hebrew's way of saying "a tower of great height." The spies described the cities as great and "walled up to heaven," and Moses repeats this in his farewell speech, Deuteronomy 1:28; 9:1. High mountains are mountains that mount up to heaven. The meaning of the phrase is, therefore, that they wished to build an uncommonly high skyscraper. The design was practicable as the context shows. They wanted to build it as a token of their unity and fame. The latter is expressed by the word "Shem," name. God had blessed Shem. They wanted to make a "Shem" for themselves and they wanted it as a community-house and community-church. God had said to subdue the earth; but they were wiser than God, just as our modern Babel builders are. We know that God has made a perfect and seven-fold unity of the Spirit, Ephesians 4:1-6. All we have to do is to believe and keep it, but ignoring this divine unity or sacred union, man wants to build his one world and his one world church, and for a brief season under the Antichrist he will seem to succeed as Revelations 13 shows.

LET US-Genesis 11:7

Subordinationism seems to be in the air these days. Many have nice weasel words for Jesus but they deny His Godhead. They say He was generated by the will of the Father. This would mean that Christ is not absolutely necessary since God could have also willed otherwise. According to this view He is God, but not *the* God, divine, but not in the same sense as the Father. God made all things by the Son, but the Son is not the real Creator. His Spirit is only the first creation and not the third Person in the blessed Being of God. In the eighteenth century Samuel Clark and many others began to hold this view about the sonship of Christ. Arius went a step farther than Origen when he made the Son the first creature and not of one substance or essence with the Father. Carefully watch against all subordination of the Son to the Father. As Mediator and servant of course He was absolutely subordinate and subservient to the Father, but not essentially as the Son of God. The more glory we give to the Son the better. How do the Jews explain the divine consultations as found in Genesis 1:26; 3:22 and 11:7? The Rabbinical writers say that He consulted with the angels, but from the fact that angels are only creatures we can safely lay this thought aside. Neither would it be consistent with the statement of Isaiah 40:14 and a similar statement in the last part of Romans 11. When man was created there was as it were a conference by the persons of Holy Trinity, intimating what a marvelous creation man is in contradistinction to all other creatures.

What do the Jews say about the so-called divine consultations which we find in different places of the Old Testament? Genesis 1:26; 3:22; 11:7; Isaiah 6:8. The Jews generally say as a mere subterfuge that He consulted with the angels. They cannot deny that here is a plurality

of persons, but they will not admit that there are three divine Persons in the one Holy Being of God. They did admit it before Christ, but they began to deny this violently after the Christians confessed Him as God.

THE LORD DID THERE CONFOUND THE LANGUAGE OF ALL THE EARTH

Genesis 11:9

Generally this is taken to mean that all languages were confounded and confused, but it just said in verse one that the whole earth was of one language and of one speech. These words even forbid us to think of the whole world, for it says "there" namely in the plain of Shinar, or Babylon. Then *Kol arets* does not always mean all the earth. In this very chapter and context the regions of Shinar is called *Arets Shinar. So is* Canaan *Arets Canaan.* The word "Arets" often means land, region, province, and the Lord here emphasizes the fact that He there in Babylon's plain created confusion. Centuries later the patriarchs and Moses and Joshua conversed with ease with the nations of Midian and Canaan without the help of interpreters.

LET US GO DOWN AND CONFOUND THEIR LIP.

This is what it really says. This word "lip" *shaphach* seems to substantiate the thought of many that God miraculously caused some labial trouble. The word is not "lashon," "tongue" but "shaphach," lip. We have no ground for the assertions that all languages were confused, for there was hitherto but the one Hebrew language. Nor have we reason to state that this one language was all at once spoiled and unintelligible, for long after Abraham the Semite could easily hold a conversation with the men of Canaan. From many facts it is clear that Hebrew was the vernacular and universal tongue at that time.

THE END OF THE CONFUSION OF TONGUES--Genesis 11

The tongues of Pentecost were not the full and final cure for the Babylonian confusion of language. In our day many missionary folk have not solved this problem, but rather added to the confusion. God has clearly revealed, however, that this judgment will be removed after the day He has risen up to the prey, and after the pouring out of His indignation upon the Kingdoms. Then will He turn to the peoples a pure language that they may pray and serve Him with one consent, Zephaniah 3:8. In the original *language* is *lip, saphah* from *sepheth,* a lip, and so *speech, language*. The purified lips stand opposed to the "unclean lips" of Isaiah 6:5. "With one consent" is with one *shoulder,* like oxen to pull together under one yoke. In the verse 8 all the letters of the Hebrew alphabet are found and this implies according to the Rabbies and Bullinger that this verse takes in the whole plan of God concerning Israel. The whole climax is here certainly given, and not only concerning Israel but also regarding the nations of the earth. The world's problems cannot be solved by the world itself. A higher and transcendent power is needed. The confusion of tongues must be taken away, and man with his unclean lips cannot do

this, but Christ shall descend from heaven as He said and He shall give all the nations a purified lip, and united prayer, with united willingness and harmonious service of the so long rejected Son of God.

DEVOLUTION-Genesis 12:50

Human history is not one of progress but of deterioration. Mechanically and educationally, and from the view point of the inventions, the world has never made such wonderful progress as in the last fifty years, but from a moral point of view there is no progress but in many ways retrogression. We find the law of degeneracy operative in the holy people of God. Take the Patriarchs for an example. Abraham was great in every respect just as God promised, Isaac was an insignificant little tent dweller in comparison to his heroic father. Jacob was not as noble and great as his father, and his sons were positively mean, at least mean enough to sell their own brother and to deceive their old father. In the kings of Israel and Judah we see the same law of devolution instead of evolution. See also II Timothy 4:1-5; II Peter 2; Jude; Revelation 2 and 3.

REMEMBER LOT-Genesis 13, 14

Lot is called a "just man, vexed with the filthy conversation of Sodom." God covered this man with the mantle of His love while he holily depicted his sins in the Old Testament. But it makes a difference for God upon what side of Calvary He looks at a man. Beyond Calvary He sees all the spots on His own, but on this side of Calvary He does not see them any longer. Strange that those who had their own sins nailed there can stumble so often over the sins of others. Strange that they can as dear children not be better followers of God in the appreciation of Calvary's sin destroying power. It must be conceded, however, that Lot is a type of the carnal believer, who chose grass where Abraham chose grace. There were six downward steps in Lot's course.

He strove, Genesis 13:7.

He looked with lustful eye, 13:10.

He chose selfishly, 13:11.

He pitched toward Sodom, 13:12.

He dwelt in Sodom, 13:12.

He sat in the gate, 19:1.

And finally he got burned out. He is a picture of the believer who rests upon the one foundation but who has built hay, wood and stubble upon that one foundation and sees all his work burned, but himself saved as by fire. See I Corinthians 3:11-15

MELCHIZEDEK-Genesis 14

The Jews often thought that he was Shem. We find him in history here, later in Psalms 110 and finally in Hebrews 7.

He was a king and a grand type of Christ as can be seen from the following parallels:

Both had an unknown origin, incomprehensible at least for the intellect was the origin of our Lord.

Both stood unique and alone.

Both were King and Priest in one.

Both were King of righteousness and thereafter King of peace.

Both stood aloof from the priestly line of Levi.

Both were more than Abraham.

Both quicken the weary with bread and wine.

Both help and bless Israel.

Both receive gifts from Israel.

Both receive great homage.

ELYON OF THE MOST HIGH-Genesis 14:18-22

This name appears fifty-nine times, the first time of Melchizedek as priest of the Most High God, appearing four times in connection with him.

The second time it appears again with a stranger, now Balaam, Numbers 24:16.

The third time it appears as a divine name it is used again in connection with the nations, Deuteronomy 32:8.

The fourth time it is in connection with Christ's appearing in David's jubilation, II Samuel 22:14. David singing again of the Lord's coming uses Elyon also in Psalms 7:17; 9:2; 18:13; 21:7; 46:45; 47:2,3; 57:2,3; 73:11, 77:10; etc. Satan once said, "I will be like Elyon," Isaiah 14:14. In Daniel this name is four times used of the greatness of God in regard to the heathen and His rule and judgment of the wicked.

Barring four exceptions in the poetry of the Psalms God was generally not addressed as the *Elyon*, as in Genesis 14:20, 22, because it denotes His absolute sovereignty over the wicked and the heathen. From the use of this divine name it is evident that our Lord Jesus Christ is the Elyon. In Greek this word became *helium*, since the sun was to the ancient heathen a high god, and in this way it has entered into our scientific terminology.

THE SHIELDS OF THE BIBLE-Genesis 15:1

The shield was anciently the most used defensive weapon. In the Old Testament four words have been translated "shield."

The *tsinnah* is like the Greek *thureos,* "door" designed to protect the whole body. They were of oxhide as a rule or thin wood covered with leather, that they could easily be burned, Ezekiel 39:9. Such a shield is mentioned in Psalms 5:12; 91:4. It often was carried by a special armor-bearer, I Samuel 17:7, 41. The *magen* was smaller and is also called buckler or target. This covered the head and was used in hand to hand combat. This word is well known in the modern *magen* David.

The *shelet* is a shield whose form is not so well known. It is also translated *quiver* but it was clearly a shield as appears from II Kings 11:10; II Chronicles 23:9; II Samuel 8:7; I Chronicles 18:7,8.

The *sokerah* is found only in a poetic sense in Psalms 91:4.

These various shields alone, however, are sufficient to show man's ingenuity for war-making. War is one of man's oldest and most practiced arts, and dreamers are all those who think they can change man's bellicose heart.

A shield came forth from the death and the skin of the bull. This reminds of protection through Calvary's blood. The golden shields of Rehoboam were stolen by Egypt and replaced by shields of brass. Before war the shields were anointed II Samuel 1:21; Isaiah 21:5. They were in war often red with blood, Nah. 2:3. "Thou wilt crown him with Thy favor as with a shield." Modern chiefs in Ethiopia and other parts of Africa are often crowned upon their shields. The shield as trophies of victory were put in the temples. Goliath's shield and Had-arezer's shields were put there. The buckler was a light shield.

ABRAHAM DROVE THEM AWAY-Genesis 15:11

"Withstand the devil and he shall flee from you." "Give no place to the devil." Our Lord explained the fowls of Satan. The deep sleep that fell upon Adam was a miraculous sleep and we find the same word here. The Jewish scholars translated it by *ecstacy* in the Septuagint, meaning thereby to bring out the idea that it was a miraculous sleep sent and designed by God for the purpose of divine revelation. As with Adam so that sleep here points to the sleep of death on Calvary by the Prince of glory. The horror of great darkness points vividly to the great suffering and great darkness that fell upon Christ on the Cross. In His explanation of this story the Lord shows that there will be an immediate or at least a germinant and nearby fulfillment of this sleep, when He gives the prediction of Israel's stay and suffering in Egypt. Twice we are told that the sun went down, and this points to the long night of Israel's suffering, just like the sunrise is often emblematic of Israel's redemption.

This piece as a whole is therefore rich in spiritual and typical lessons. It should here be added that as the smoking furnace points to Israel's suffering in Egypt during the four generations of Levi, Kohath, Amram and Moses, so the lamp typifies the perpetual presence of

the Lord and His grace in the midst of His suffering people. Up to this time God was wont to say to Abraham: "I will give these this land," but after this wonderful entering upon the covenant, He says: "I have given thee this land."

HE STAGGERED NOT-Romans 4:20

How can we reconcile this statement of Romans 4 that Abraham staggered not in unbelief, when we see him in the story of Genesis repeatedly in unbelief? This question is often asked.

Many preachers can be very harsh on Abraham's slips. They have not fully taken God's attitude to him and they do not seem to know what grace means. Grace means that God fully forgives and forgets. In the Old Testament He uses the sins of the saints as warning beacons, but He does not even do this in the New Testament. He there has buried their sins, blotted them out and forgotten them, and He only exalts their faith. What is said here of Abraham is also true of David and of all the ancient worthies where the sins of even a Samson and Gideon are not mentioned, but their faith is shining on the page of Holy Writ. Then, the Lord does not forget what we so often forget that Satan uses all his trickery and chicanery against God's men. It is true that Abraham went down to Egypt and the Philistines and that he lied twice about his wife and that he used Hagar his maid. All this proves not only that he was a man of like movement as we are, but also that he was the special object of Satan's onslaughts and designs to prevent the birth of the promised holy seed of the woman. People that serve the world and sin have easy sailing, but not so the stalwarts of faith. Satan does not waste his ammunition on dead game, but on live game. Unlike the buzzard, he does not eat dead sheep but live ones.

IS THE COVENANT MADE WITH ABRAHAM IN GENESIS 17:4-14 FOR US?

It is not. Let us scrutinize it for a moment:

1.-God made it with Abraham of whom He said: "I will make nations of thee, and kings shall come out of thee." In the church is no nation of Jew or Greek, Barbarian or Scythian, nor have kings come out of her; but a few kings have come into her.

2.-"I will give unto thee and to they seed after thee the land, wherein thou art a stranger, all the land of Canaan for an everlasting possession," verse 8. This certainly could not be said of the Church who has not been set with Christ in Canaan, but in heavenly places, Ephesians 2:6.

3.-"This is my covenant - Every man child among you shall be circumcised." This again could not be said of the Church because the Apostle said in Galatians: "If I am yet circumcised, Christ is vain."

4.-"And the uncircumcised man child whose flesh of his foreskin is not circumcised, that soul shall be cut off from his people; he hath broken my covenant." Again this could not be said of the Church. Get this well. If we are circumcised Christ is vain, if we are not circumcised we must be killed. These words then make it plain that this covenant is not for the Church. See also Romans 9:4, 5.

THE CHANGE OF NAME-Genesis 17:5

This was far more important to Israel than to us, especially when God-given as in the case of Abram and Sarai. Many conflicting opinions have been given on the change of these two names, some of which are "inane," "puerile," and "absurd" and to many is it simply a change from *father of the many* to *father of many*. Roy says in his Hebrew Lexicon that the former represents a limited number, and Abraham an unlimited, indefinite, and innumerable number, and that may be true, but the very simplest and richest idea is that God put His own rich name Jehovah abbreviated as so often, in the name of Abram and so made it Abraham. Typically this would point to the fact that Jehovah-Jesus would some day dwell in Abraham's seed. With Sarai we have the same thing. It means *my princess* and now she becomes His through His indwelling.

CIRCUMCISION-Genesis 17:23-27

It had a four-fold meaning:

1.-It was instituted first of all for hygienic reasons. The doctors in our day have almost universally returned to it for reasons of health and purity. In the hot climates especially was it found to be necessary.

2.-It had later a civic purpose, since it incorporated into Israel and made a citizen of Israel.

3.--Symbolically it stood for the violent and bloody excision of the old man represented by the foreskin. Our Lord was treated as an old sinner in Adam when he was circumcised.

4. Typically and prophetically it pointed to the true circumcision of Calvary where the Lord of glory was treated like the old men and violently cut off out of the land of the living. Through the Cross we have the antitypical circumcision and baptism, Colossians 2:11-12.

FEET WASHING-Genesis 18:4

The Angels who visited Abraham had their feet washed. On the golden boulevard of the New Jerusalem this was not necessary but in vile Sodom it was sorely needed. The Sodom of this world defiles angels externally even if it does not contaminate them internally. Abraham's servant in Mesopotamia, Genesis 24:32 and Joseph's brethren in Egypt had their feet washed, Genesis 43:24. It was and is still in our day the universal custom of the East. To wash the feet was a menial task and belonged to the slaves. Abigail, wife of a rich farmer, greatly humbled herself when she called herself a handmaid and slave `'to wash the feet of the servants of my Lord," I Samuel 25:41. Simon showed his contempt when he did not wash the Master's feet, Luke 7:44. While Christ Himself greatly humbled Himself by washing the feet of the disciples, John 13:5, 10. It is shortsighted, however, to see only an Eastern custom in this. Up to date medical science tells us that it is one of the most healthful things to wash and rub the feet daily. It greatly helps the circulation of the blood which otherwise is often poor in the extremities. There are still well-meaning folk in our land who occasionally wash

one another's feet. The Lord will not withdraw His smile from them on that account for this is in reality much better than that they whitewash themselves.

THREE MEASURES OF FINE MEAL-Genesis 18:6

This is the first time we read of the fine meal of fine flour in the Bible. The word is used approximately one hundred times and is the standing type of the fine, lovely, smooth, white, pure, nourishing life of Christ in whom there was no foreign substance but only grace, purity, love, holiness, and perfect smoothness. All roughness and rudeness was far from Him. Often the fine flour was mingled with oil, Leviticus 2:7; 7:12; Numbers 6:15; and in Numbers 7 we find this ordered twelve times. The oil typified the Holy Spirit as the fine flour foreshadowed the human nature of Christ. He was filled with the Spirit if anyone ever was. The *soleth* or fine flour, may have given rise to the word "solemnity" which we received from the Latins and which originally meant to sacrifice with *soleth,* or an offering of fine flour. When we speak of a solemn occasion, we have forgotten the origin of this word, just as when we speak of an *ovation* we do not think of the fact that this word originated in the sacrifice of a sheep at some minor triumph.

ABRAHAM A MYTH?--Genesis 18:17

Radical critics claim that Abraham is a myth, a fable, fiction, or a bit of folklore. The critics think they know more than our Lord who certainly believed in the historicity of Abraham for He said: "Before Abraham was I Am." "Paul believed that Abraham existed, for he says that he believed God and that it was accounted to him for righteousness." On their own theory we can prove that the critics are a myth. If Abraham was a myth, Isaac was a myth, and Jacob was a myth. If father Jacob was a myth, then the twelve patriarchs were myths, and if these are myths, then all the Hebrews are myths, and if all the Jews are myths, then Christ is a myth, and all the apostles are myths, and if all the early Christians were myths, then all Christians now are myths. And finally, if all Christians now are myths, then the higher critics, who still want to be Christians, are myths and nothing more.

If Abraham is a myth, then all his faith, travels, prayers and actions are mythical. Then he never fell on his face and laughed.

HE LINGERED-Genesis 19:16

Lingering Lot! *When* did he linger? The very morn when Sodom was to be destroyed.

Where did he linger? Within the reeking walls of Sodom itself.

Why did he linger? Because Sodom was dearer to him than the commanding Word of God.

Before whom did he linger? Before the eyes of two angels sent to deliver him and his family. The more you consider the circumstances the more astounding it becomes. Lot knew Sodom's iniquity. He knew its cry "had waxen great before the Lord," verse 13, yet he lingered. Lot knew the judgment was coming, for the angels had emphatically told him, still he lingered. He had even warned others to flee from the place, but he himself lingered, verse 14. The command from heaven was plain: "Arise lest thou be consumed in the iniquity of the city," verse 15; nevertheless he lingered. He was slow, cold, backward, trifling, loitering when he should have been forward, hot, hastening, hurrying. Lot is a fit type of those believers who have much light and at the same time much levity and lukewarmness, who combine with high knowledge of the truth, low lives and little love and zeal. They spend their lives in beholding the beauties of Sodom and in trying to ameliorate conditions in Sodom or in working up a revival in Sodom. They put judgment far off and say in their heart: "My Lord delays His coming." While others walk with God, they try to keep step with the world and mix perfume with Sodom's stench. With our modern Lots there are no questionable amusements; they run the whole gamut of carnal pleasure and sweetly rest on Sunday morning. O lingering Lots, make haste for there is danger and death in delay.

I CANNOT DO ANYTHING TILL THOU BE COME THITHER-Genesis 19:22

The Angel Jehovah said this remarkable word. He is omnipotent, yet here is a thing He cannot do, O glorious impotence! What is it that God cannot do? Here is a worthwhile riddle. What is the answer? He cannot lie. Praise Him, right, but that is not the riddle here. Here is something He cannot do. He could destroy the whole of Sodom with all its wealth and all its men, women, babes, and cattle, but one filthy man he could not destroy with Sodom. He could not even destroy Sodom as long as he lingered in it. That Lot had become besmirched with Sodom's slime the last part of this chapter clearly shows, but God calls him three times in II Peter *just* in the sense of *justified*, and God reverently speaking, cannot destroy a justified man. He cannot go back upon His own justification, nor can *He* first exact pay from the Surety and Substitute, and then from the person covered by the Surety. The just judge of all the earth cannot do this. What a volume of comfort lies here in regard to the eternal security of the believer; and what a volume of teaching in regard to the pre-tribulation rapture of the believers. We can bank upon it that it is a rule of God's blessed Book and in all His actions that in all judgments He thinks first of the safety of the justified, and He cannot destroy the justified with the wicked. Oh my dear soul, do not debate about eternal security and the pre-tribulation rapture, for these stand high above all debate. This word clearly tells us so.

THE DEAD SEA: SEA OF LOT-Genesis 19:30

The Arabs call this sea at present: *Bahr Lut*, the Sea of Lot, suggested, of course, by the history of Lot. Josephus called it the Asphalt Lake, from the asphaltum or bitumen found in it. The Bible never calls it the Dead Sea, though this is a proper and fit name because everything in it and around it is dead. The fish the Jordan sends into it die at the very mouth

of the river because of its great quantities of salt, potassium, and other chemicals. The Bible has three names for this strangest of all seas:

The *Salt Sea,* Genesis 14:3; Numbers 34:3, 12; Deuteronomy 3:17; Joshua 3:16; 15:2, 5; 18:19.

The *Sea of Arabah,* or *Sea of the Plain,* Deuteronomy 3:17; 4:49; II Kings 14:25.

The *East Sea,* so called in contradistinction from the Mediterranean, which is called the Western Sea, Ezekiel 47:18; Joel 2:20.

This remarkable body of water after so many centuries still speaks with eloquent tongue of the holiness of God and the certainty and dreadfulness of His judgments. Still, sinful man around this sea lives on in sin and does not take it to heart. Man seems to be the most indocile creature in all the universe. Sun and moon stood still at His command, but man rushes with breakneck speed on to God's dreadful judgments.

This sea like many church members always takes in the living waters of Jordan and of many rivulets, but it never gives out. It has not a single outlet. In and around it is nothing but death and desolation. It is the standing emblem of the sinner and his selfish life.

ABRAHAM AND LOT

Great was the difference between these two men. Abraham chose grace, Lot grass, as Leon Tucker said. Abraham talked to God, Lot to the mocking Sodomites.

Abraham looked for a city, Lot crept in Sodom. Abraham was a pilgrim, Lot was at home in vile Sodom. Abraham feared contamination of his son, Lot contaminated his own girls.

Abraham was willing to be the least, Lot desired to be the greatest.

Abraham was generous, Lot greedy.

Abraham was an heir of the world, Lot of Ammon and Moab.

Abraham got in a cave when dead, Lot when alive.

Abraham entertained angels, these refused to come in Lot's house.

Abraham rescued Lot, Lot was a drag on Abraham.

Abraham prayed for Sodom, Lot was the joke of his sons when he preached.

Abraham was a nobleman, Lot a caveman.

Abraham became heir of the world, Lot got burned out.

Abraham's Sarah is honored, Lot's wife petrified.

CAST OUT THIS BONDWOMAN AND HER SON

Genesis 21:10

Can we say that law and grace are absolutely opposite principles? They are found both in the Word of God and hence both divine in that sense, but dispensationally and practically God himself has put them in opposition to each other in words like this: "And if by grace, then it is no more of works, otherwise grace is no more grace. But if it be of works, then it is no more grace, otherwise work is no more work," Romans 11:6. Here God set them forth as contradictory principles. In the story of Hagar as explained by Galatians 4 we find the same exclusive contrast. Hagar, representing law and works, could not stay in the house of Abraham, representing faith, grace and liberty. Many try today to keep Hagar in the house of free grace but always with calamitous results for the spiritual life. This mixture of law and grace is now called Galatianism, against which Paul has thundered in his letter to the Galatians. Hagar dwells today in most churches, making them stiff and starchy, cold and condemnatory. God said: "Cast her out."

A RAM CAUGHT-Genesis 22:13

Beautiful substitution!

Is the idea of substitution in connection with the Atonement fair? Do our moral feelings and our sense of justice not rebel against the idea that one sins and another suffers? And does the Bible not say: "The soul that sinneth it shall die." Would this not exclude an innocent substitute in the place of the guilty? The law of substitution is found in all Scripture and here also the rule applies: God started the business. If we kick, we kick Him in the face, and who are we with our feelings to sit in judgment upon Him? He killed back there in Eden the innocent lamb to clothe the two guilty nudists with their flimsy covering of fig leaves. Ten righteous would have saved Sodom. These then could not have been spared upon their own merits, but they could have been spared for the Just's sake. Here then was the just for the unjust. God would have spared Jerusalem for one righteous man's sake, here also the just for the unjust. He saved the boat full of soldiers for the one righteous Paul. God sought in vain for a man to stand in the gap, Jeremiah 5:1; Ezekiel 22:30. Christ was the only one who could stand in the breach for us on Calvary. No one but Jesus our Lord could or would be surety for a guilty race.

BEHOLD THE FIRE AND THE WORD-Genesis 22:7

The cross of Calvary threw its shadow four thousand years back. See that innocent victim whose skin formed a covering for the nakedness of our first parents. It is well to see that it was *one* skin for the word is in the singular in Hebrew. It arrayed our parents as a substitution for the fig leaves of their self-covering. The firstling of Abel's flock was a second shadow of the same cross of Calvary.

The altar erected by Abraham on Mount Moriah is another wondrous shadow of the cross of Calvary. This chapter alone furnishes absolute proof for the inspiration of the Bible. For one thing it is indubitably the same spot as where stood the cross of Christ.

God tempted Abraham, i.e., put him to the test. He tried his faith sorely. When Satan tempts he wants to bring out the evil, when God tries He wants to bring out His own grace to the full. He tried Abraham in the most severe manner. He tried him at the tenderest spot of his life, the life of his *only* real son. It reminds of John 3:16. Abraham took the wood and laid it on Isaac. "The Lord hath laid on Him an iniquity." They "went *both of them together."* Calvary was the gift of both the Father and the Son. Suddenly as they plodded on to the top of the mountain, Isaac stopped, looked at Abraham and said: "My Father," and Abraham said literally: *Behold me,* the second time he says that in this chapter, verse 1 and verse 7. Behold the heavenly father who did not spare His only begotten Son! "Here is the *fire* and the *wood,* but where is the lamb for a burnt offering?"

Behold the fire, man's fire! The history of fire is wonderful. Animals can never make fire. They never know how, whereas man always knows how to make and use fire. The wildest cannibals generally have fires for their stew. The wild Bushmen of Australia use fire. The wild men of Borneo always use fire. Somehow man always knows how, beasts never. They are always afraid of fire and shun it and run away from it. Here is a gap between man and animal!

Man first used pine knots as flame means. Even Lincoln studied Bunyan by the pine knots. Then man found out how to make and light candles. After this he made primitive lamps and burnt olive oil in them. In the Museum of Gizeh at the foot of the Pyramids are lamps of 4000 years ago.

As civilization goes on man makes bigger and bigger fires. He puts now whole cities into flame and ashes in ten minutes. He burns big hotels and 120 people with it. Some half crazed drunken man or woman lit their cigarette and then fell asleep. The hotel in Atlanta, Georgia had on its stationery: "Absolutely fireproof." I believe it, but it was not foolproof. As it is now with our modern drink and cigarettes, there is not one hotel in the country safe and secure. The two general evils of drink and cigarette have made it so.

Behold the *wood!* Man also has plenty of wood. There is still wood enough in the world to build each man a fine house, but man burns it in fruitless wars. Wood comes from the tree and only God can make a tree. The waters of life have been embittered as at *Marah.* The people were thirsty but could not drink the water. Man has plenty water too but much of it is no good. What was Cod's cure? A tree. How this points to Calvary.

But where is the lamb for a burnt offering? We have plenty fire, plenty wood, plenty water. But where is the *lamb?* Let us send the challenge to Israel. Where is the lamb? "We have white and black roosters, but no lamb." The *thora* does not know a thing about roosters. These are not even mentioned in the Old Testament.

Angels, where is the Lamb? Michael tell us. Gabriel tell us. All ye angelic hosts tell us. The Lamb is slain and stands in the midst of the throne! They cry in unison.

Christendom where is the Lamb? Oh we are through with the lamb. We are working and waiting for the beast. History where is the lamb? John the Baptist, where is the lamb? "Be-

hold the lamb of God which taketh away the sin of the world." That Lamb is for the burnt offering. The wrath of God burnt Him on Calvary for us.

THE MANNER OF BARGAINING IN THE EAST - Genesis 23:5, 6

We see how the Eastern folk bargain. Ekron says three times to Abraham: "I give it thee," but he knows that Abraham will not take him up. This apparent generosity is nothing but a sly *captatio benevolentiae*, a captivating of the good will of the of the buyer, so that he from his side may also be bighearted and liberal in his price. I asked an Oriental: "What do you want for this guide book?" He said: "I give it thee." I said: "Thank you." He was mad, but he got plenty from me. They never frankly state the price, but slyly they try to elicit great generosity. *Do ut des!* It is on the market of free grace alone that we can buy without money and without price. Thank God, the very best can be had by every poor and undone sinner for nothing. He justifies freely the ungodly, and to him who "worketh not." "The wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is eternal life." Oh that the teeming millions might realize that salvation is a gift and that the gift and calling of God are without repentance.

THE IDEA OF A MEDIATOR-Genesis 23:8

"Entreat for me to Ephron," said Abraham. He did not go directly to Abraham but he got someone of the Hittites to plead for him, and so no serious business of any kind is transacted without the help of a middleman or dragoman. In job he is called the *daysman.* It all goes to illustrate the great task of the Mediator between God and man, the man Christ Jesus.

Our blessed Lord came all the way from glory to mediate between God and man. His was the most serious, solemn task of tasks, and how wonderfully He accomplished it on the cursed tree.

In theology mediation is a regulative thought. Christ's sacrifice on Calvary was His priestly mediation of reconciliation. Godward His sacrifice was a propitiation, which fully satisfied all of God's demands as the judge of the universe; in regard to man it justifies him freely by faith in Christ.

Seated on His Father's right hand Christ has the ministry or mediatorship of intercession. Faint shadows of this were Jonathan's intercession for David, I Samuel 19:4; Abigail's intercession for Nabal before David, I Samuel 25:18-31; the king of Syria for Naaman before the king of Israel, II Kings 5:6. Abraham intercedes for Abimelech, Genesis 20:7-17; also for Sodom, 18:23. Moses interceded several times for Pharoah, Exodus 8:8, 30; 9:28-33; 10:17; for Israel, Exodus 17:11; 33:13; Deuteronomy 9:18. Samuel was a great intercessor, Samuel 8:21; 12:19,23; Job and Jeremiah also, Jeremiah 15:1; Job 42:8.

Seeing that God as such is an invisible Spirit the Son will be forever the Mediator of union between God and man.

BRACELETS-Genesis 24

The fashion, *schema,* of this world passeth away, but the fashions of this world do not pass away until the present sinful form of this cosmos itself passes away. The girls in Abraham's time, over four thousand years ago, loved to have glittering bracelets on their hands as we see in the girl Rebekah, who was to become the bride of Isaac. Three times in Genesis 24 we read of *bracelets.* We read of them in a similar way in Numbers 31:50; Ezekiel 16:11; 23:42, whereas the word translated *covering* in Numbers 19:15 also means *bracelet.* The word *tzamid is* bracelet and this is used in all the seven times it is used.

These bracelets and other ornaments of Rebekah sweetened the hardships of her bride through the desert trek. They assured her of the riches of her invisible lover. They were a guarantee that he was liberal and that he loved her and was waiting for his bride to be fully united with her. In passing through life's wilderness we likewise have the earnest of God's Spirit to assure us that the happy meeting with our unseen Lover will soon be a bright reality. "Whom having not seen, yet we love." "Oh, Jesus, Lover of our souls, let us to thy bosom fly!"

ROOM FOR THE CAMELS-Genesis 24:31

Our word camel comes directly from the Hebrew *gamul*. It has been taken over in almost all the European languages. In the Dutch it has two forms: *kemel* and *kameel*. Much confusion exists in the minds of the people between a camel, a dromedary, and the two-humped camel. Some think that they are three animals but they are one animal of three different sorts. A dromedary is a light and swift camel used for very fast travel and not for heavy loads. The difference between the two is as that of the swift, light race horse and the Belgian dray horse; whereas the Bactrian camel alone has two humps plus a very poisonous breath, so that the cameleers or camel drivers of this beast never get old. The two-humped bactrian camel is very strong but not swift, and is, therefore, alawys a beast of burden. This Hebrew word enriched our English with *camel's hair, cameleer, camelry, camel-caravan, camelopard,* and the expression *to swallow a camel*. The word *gamal* is derived from the verb *gamal*, to do good, to recompense, to reward. This name expresses exactly what the camel does to Israel. The Arabs could not do without it. It is the ship of the desert, their friend, their fuel, their meat, their drink, their raiment, their reward for toil and trouble.

THE VOW IN ISRAEL-Genesis 28:20

A vow is a voluntary promise to do something for God or to abstain from something for His sake. It was mostly free; in only a few cases was it imposed by the law. Several times we read the conditional, "if a man vow a vow." As with the tithes, so Jacob was the first also with the vows, Genesis 28:20. In Numbers 30 we have the vow-chapter, the voluntary vow being mentioned thirteen times. Of the different persons we find that the following made a vow to God: Jacob, Jephthah, Judges 11:30, 39; Hannah, I Samuel 1:11; Absalom claimed

that he had made a vow, 11 Samuel 15:7, 8; David, Psalms 22:25; Jonah and the heathen sailors, Jonah 1:16; 2:9, 10. The Hebrew word for vow is "neder;" a word that occurs with the verb fully a hundred times.

As long as the temple stood there were vows and we see in Acts that Paul fully honored them in a Levitical way, but after Acts 28, where Israel is placed for this age under judicial punishment we never read of vows in the prison epistles. They do not, and can not belong to the members of His Body blessed with all spiritual blessings, Ephesians 1:3. If God has given all away then He cannot, reverently speaking, give any besides.

IN TIME TO COME-Genesis 30:33

The word "machar" which is still recognizable as our "morrow," means "tomorrow" and has been thus translated nearly one hundred times. When thy son asketh thee in time to come, Deuteronomy 6:20 "tomorrow;" same in Joshua 4:6, 21; 22:24, 27, 28. Our human future is only a tomorrow, for we are but flies of a day and we fly away. God wants to remind man who always acts and lives as if he were to be here forever that our future is but a moment a "tomorrow." Our present is man's day, our future an unknown tomorrow, and no one knows what it will bring. God says: "Today as ye hear my will, harden not your hearts." May we number our days in order that we may apply our hearts unto wisdom, because we are not even certain of tomorrow. Man is like Pharoah an inveterate procrastinator, but God solemnly warns him: "Today, as ye hear my voice, harden not your heart," - just a thing the masses daily do. Many are so gospel-hardened that the love of God in Christ, the atoning blood of Calvary, the coming Christ and heaven and hell mean nothing to them. They have heard and slighted it a thousand times, and soon they shall believe the lie that they all might be damned who receive not the love for the truth.

CHESTNUT-Genesis 30:37-43

The R. V. has followed the "platanos" of the Septuagint version and has translated it correctly "plane tree." This tree will practically grow in all climates, but it prefers the water. It is abundant in the land and grows with the willow and poplar on the side of streams. The name "armon" is derived from a root meaning "nakedness." In all probability it is so called from its annually throwing off of its outer bark. The Dutch word "arm" *poor* still means "naked," "bereft," "destitute." The trick of Jacob was successful. It has often been tried, but never with success. It is a biological impossibility as every farmer boy knows. Why was it then successful with Jacob? For the simple reason that the God of Jacob, the God of Israel, who alone doeth wondrous things, worked here a great miracle in behalf of his child who was cheated for twenty years. During the age of grace in which we live and during which Israel is in unbelief, God does not work such miracles, nor any wonders beside those of nature and grace.

GALEED-Genesis 31:46-52

Not less than nine times we find this word in these verses. It means "a round heap." The first part of this word is the same as the "Gol" in "Gogotha," the round heap on top of our body so to say. It became the familiar name of Gilead, the mountain region east of Jordan. Laban wanted to called the heap of stones "a heap of witness" in Syrian, but Jacob called it simply in Hebrew "a round heap." Nevertheless, this round heap of stones pointed clearly to Golgotha and the stone rejected there by the builders.

1.-We have here a covenant confirmed.

2.-Enmity between two parties is removed; peace was made.

3.-A little hill is present.

4.-That little hill is "Galeed," "Golgotha" "the round skull."

5.-Blood of the innocent beasts flowed.

6.-After the blood flowed, there was an invitation.

7.-Upon the basis of the shed blood there was the joy of a festive meal and the joy of an accomplished reconciliation.

Waves are heaps of water and hence this same word "gal," "gallim" in the plural, is used for the proud rolling billows of the sea in the following places: Psalms 42:7; 65:7; 89:9, 10; 107:25, 29; Isaiah 48:18; 51:15; Jeremiah 25:22; 31:35; 51:42, 55; Ezekiel 26:3; Jonah. 2:3, 4; Zechariah 10:11. All of God's "gallim" of wrath went over Christ, Psalms 42:7 and hence we glory in Golgotha's cross. The word is also often used for "heaps of ruins." Toss up Golgotha's cross and you get heaps of ruins.

ANGELS-Genesis 32:1

The word "angel" is "messenger," "melek." The Word of God gives the impression that the angels are innumerable. It speaks of holy angels, Mark 8:38; Luke 9:26; of wicked angels, II Peter 2:4; Jude 6; and of elect angels, I Timothy 5:21, thereby clearly implying that there were also non-elect angels, and that all that fell were non-elect or reprobate. The election of the angels must of necessity be conceived as supralapsarian i.e. God did not choose a certain number out of a fallen mass of angels. Neither were they like the believers chosen in Christ, for as Christ's servants, the angels are not mystically in Him and never will be, because they are His servants and stand before Him. The saints can never finally fall and be lost, since they not only stand before Him as servants but are in Him. If God had not elected some angels, not one would have remained holy. Their perseverance lies in His election.

MAHANAIM-Genesis 32:2,3

The word means "two hosts." They were God's hosts sent to meet Jacob. The angelic hosts are always sent forth to minister to Israel and not to the Body of Christ. Contrariwise, the Church proclaims the manifold grace and wisdom of God to the invisible powers, Ephesians 3:9-11. Instead of the angels serving us, we serve them in this age. We find this word meaning "host," "camp," "band," "group," "company," in the singular in the expression "Mahaneh-Dan," the camp of Dan, Jude 18:12. This is the place where David tarried when expelled from his throne by Absalom and where the old Barzillai brought him many refreshing presents, II Samuel 19. The place seems to have remained honored in Israel. Why did Jacob speak of two hosts? Because God had so abundantly blessed him that he had broken out into a large host and now God sent another host to protect him. Jacob should not have been filled with such a morbid dread and dire distress with such a protecting host from heaven, but oh, the fearing human heart is always ready to cast out love in which there is no fear. Love casts out fear and conversely fear casts out love, as we can observe daily.

THE FORD OF JABBOK-Genesis 32:22, 23

The word for "ford" does not denote any construction or ferry but simply a place where the water was shallow and a passage could easily be made. The word "maavar" comes from the verb "avar" "to cross over," while the particle "ma" denotes the place. Hence the ford is a place to cross a stream and this was naturally the shallow place. The spies were pursued unto the way to Jordan unto the "fords," Joshua 2:7. Here the word is the feminine of "ma-avar." The Philistines went out to the "passage," "ma-avar," I Samuel 13:23. The "fords" of Jordan where the regular shallow places of Jordan, where passage was wont to be made. They undoubtedly stepped from boulder to boulder. What is called in judges 3 : 28 "fords" is called in 12: 5, 6 "passages." Also in I Samuel 14:4 and Isaiah 10:29. In 16:2 we read of the "fords" of Arnon, showing that the word is applied to any passable place of any stream. Isaiah 30:32 it is translated: "Every place where shall pass the grounded staff," which should be as the margin has it: "every *passing* of the rod." The word "ferry" is found only once in connection with David's passage over Jordan. It is probable that this ferry was hastily constructed for the King and his household on that occasion for we never read of it again.

HE HALTETH-Genesis 32:31

"I will assemble her that halteth," says God in Micah 4:6.

God promises great things in the context. Nothing less than a peaceful and converted world. We can make it a rule of prophetic interpretation, however, that when God says glorious things of the nations of the earth, then He must speak in that connection of Israel's restoration, and thus we find it here. He will think of His halting Jacob, for is He not the God of Jacob? He halted upon his thigh, we read of Jacob in Genesis 32:31, 32; and with a direct allusion to that episode in Jacob's life at Peniel, we read here: "I will assemble her that "halteth." The same verb "tzala" is used and not "pesach" which also means "to limp," "to halt." The halting Jacob that is finally

saved will be the elect remnant, but that remnant will at the same time be representing the whole elect nation. A third time does Scripture allude to the halting Jacob of Peniel when it says in Zepheniah 3:19: "I will save her that halteth." Jacob the halting shall take the prey. All nations hate Jacob but God is the God of halting, limping Jacob, and Jacob shall take the world's prey, not the anti-semite Hitlers. God will take the crawling worm of Jacob and thresh the mountains or kingdoms with it. Jacob halts among the nations and it is a vivid reminder that he soon will take the world's prey.

TRADE IN THE EARLY CIVILIZATION-Genesis 33:19

As vehemently as we may deny the transmutation of species, so readily should we grant external progress in civilization. Patriarchal life at first was simple and the intercourse with the outer world was meager and few and far between. In their trade they bartered the produce of the ground and the lambs of the flock and the cattle. Later came the introduction of precious metals: these at first were not put out in coins but weighed out to the seller. The third step is the use of coin which seems to have been first put out in Egypt. Of Abraham we read in civilization's dawn that he possessed "sheep and oxen, he-asses and she-asses, and camels," but subsequently, after he had returned from his residence in Egypt, at that time the hub of culture, we read that "he was rich in cattle, in silver and gold," but he still took sheep and oxen and gave them to Abimelech and he also presented to this Philistine King "seven ewe lambs" just as Ibn Saud, the Arabian King, some years ago sent a ship load of sheep to President F. D. Roosevelt.

The first recorded purchase with money we find in Abraham buying the field of Ephron with the cave of Macpelah, in order that he might bury his beloved Sarah. Here we are told that Abraham weighed to Ephron the silver current money with the merchant.

The first time that we read of pieces of money or coins is in Genesis 33:19 where Jacob buys an inheritance for his sons from the children of Hamor for one hundred pieces of money or as we would say, one hundred dollars. Here we find the expression *weighed out omitted,* and the word employed for piece of money is "kesitah," which suggests that the figure of a lamb was stamped upon it, undoubtedly because it stood for a lamb and had the worth of one lamb. Even to Job was given such a "kesitah," 42:11. The Athenians had a coin with a "bous" or ox stamped on it; it having perhaps the value of an ox. These simple points show the early progress of civilization.

ASHER-Genesis 49:20; Deuteronomy 33:24, 25

In Israel the feelings of the heart at the birth of a male child were often embodied in the name of the child and this was done at the time Asher was born. Leah was jealous because Jacob loved her sister more than her, but she was grateful that she outstripped her sister in the bringing forth of male children and so in her happy frame of mind she called her newborn son *Asher,* happy, Genesis 30:13. *Asher is* constantly almost exclusively applied to celestial bliss by the commentators but it refers first and most of all to the earthly bliss of Israel in the land. *Asher* is always applied to man's happiness never to God except that it is in Psalms 72:17 referred to the Messiah, but as man and then with Solomon as the background. The word Baruch represents a higher form of blessing since it is employed to express the bliss of God. *Asher is* expressed in Greek by *makarios* and *Baruch* by *eulogetos*.

The word *ashre,* which is the masculine plural construction of the word *Asher is* eighteen times translated *happy,* Deuteronomy 33:29; I Kings 10:8; II Chronicles 9:7; Job 5:17; Psalms 127:5; 128:1, 2; 137:8,9; 144:15; 146:5; Proverbs 3:13; 16:20; 28:14; 29:18. Some verses have it twice as where the Queen of Sheba exclaimed in rapid succession *ashre, ashre!* In the Psalms the word is nineteen times given as *blessed,* eight times elsewhere, Proverbs 8:32, 34; 20:7; Ecclesiastes 10:17; Isaiah 30:18; 32:20; 56:2; Daniel 12:12. The plural *ashre* would perhaps be best rendered by *"Oh the fulness of bliss."* This is the portion of him whose sins have been forgiven, Psalms 32:1-4.

DINAH-Genesis 34

Dinah is the feminine of Dan, judge. The "Dan" in Daniel is the same "God is my judge." We read that one day Dinah went out to see the girls of the land. Of course, she did not go to see the boys, but the boys saw her and the sad story is well known. She was "defiled." This visit had terrible results. Not only was she robbed of her purity, but Satan made a definite attempt to mix the holy seed with his own seed. Simeon and Levi in revenging their sister slew treacherously all the men of Shechem, played the Vandal, and stole all their wealth and wives and children, which made Jacob's prolonged stay most precarious and perilous. Apart from what her brothers did, this story has been often repeated in multiplied forms. Just see a show. The lust of the eyes, one third of the world. Wrong friendship, the lust of the flesh, another third of the world. Then comes the proud and cruel deed of the brothers, the vain-glory of life, and there is another third of the world, so that now all the contents of the world are present. "Obsta principiis." Watch the first step. This step is followed by other dangerous steps downward. Dinah's flesh found things too tame at home. The flesh always fights the Spirit and the Spirit ever fights the flesh. Christ crucified the flesh. Reckon your flesh to have been crucified with Him, Romans 5:11.

ALLON-BACHUTH, OAK OF WEEPING-Genesis 35:8

It is a touching little story that death of Deborah, the nursemaid of Rebekah. There was poignant grief and sorrow at her death, and they gave a special name to the spot where she was buried. As the remains of this faithful nurse were laid to rest under an oak tree, they made this hallowed spot a special landmark by calling it officially the "oak of weeping." We see several things here as (a) there were special nurse-maids at that early age; (b) these formed part of the sweet circle of the home; (c) death then as now broke the sweetest ties; (d) the bodies were reverently buried, as now, in some favored spot; (e) the tears flowed freely at the interment of a dear one; (f) Jacob was heart-broken. The word "allon," "oak," comes from the root "el," meaning "thick, strong," "lead," "before." It is the oldest name of God. Allah is to affirm by God, to swear. Think of the Allah of the Mohammedans. An *Allah* was also an oath or a confirmation by oath. An "Elah" was a "terebinth" or turpentine tree. An "Ail" is the ram of the flock that goes before in Dutch, the "doorbreker." The "Aijal" is the hart or hind; the "alejah," the strong fat tail of an oriental sheep weighing often from 30 to 50 pounds for which sometimes little wheels are made. The Orientals consider it now as in Bible times a great delicacy. The "Ulam" is the front porch or vestibule. The "Alemim," the

cornices or arches; the "Ewil," the dense, thickskulled fool, and the "ewileth" is folly or foolishness.

Even our “altar” and “altitude” and many other words are derivations from this old root.

RACHEL-Genesis 35:17-21

Here was the birth of a son near Bethlehem. Rachel is used in connection with the slaughter of the innocents as the standing emblem of Israel's love for her children and captives. Compare Jeremiah 31:15 with Matthew 2:18.

The name Ben-oni means son of sorrow, suffering, and has always been taken as a faint and yet clear type of the suffering Man of sorrow. To mother Mary Christ was only a Ben-oni.

To father Jacob the son became Benjamin, the son of the right hand, and this taken commonly as a shadow of the risen Christ who took His session at the right hand of God the Father. The type is clear: to the Mother he was the son of suffering, to the father, picture of the heavenly Father, a Son seated at the right hand of glory. To mother Mary Jesus was a son of sorrow.

The pillar set upon the grave of Rachel is there till this day. It was in Israel's hand in 1929 the only pillar in Israel's possession and towering over the wrecks of time. Even that is a reminder of the cross towering over all the wrecks of time and on which the true Benoni Benjamin died for our sins.

Death was here on the way to the goal, and so the death of Christ is the way of Glory. See Genesis 48:7.

Finally, we see here also the grace of God manifested in that though far from noble, Rachel was used in her death on a highway and while illustrating the ancient curse to woman to illustrate the Christ in His birth and suffering and exaltation at the Father's right hand. God was silent about Rachel's jealousy, idolatry and lying to her father, but He used her end to glorious ends. It was generally thought formerly that only noble men could typify Christ, but ignoble men and women could do this just as well if we only remember that He was made sin for us.

TOWER OF EDAR-Genesis 35:21

The Hebrews regarded a tower as something very great as appears from the word "migdol" related to "gadol," great. The word for "pulpit," Nehemiah 8:4 is "tower." Ezra stood on a tower of wood. God is often compared to a tower because in those days of warfare with bow and arrow and spear a tower was a safe hiding place. According to the seven different words for tower there must have been various kinds of towers:

Arnan represents a siege tower, Isaiah 23:13.

Pinnoth are the wall towers, pinnacles.

Bachan stand for watch tower.

Of el, hill, is perhaps only a sharp tower-like peak of mud.

Matsor is the rock-fortress, found only in Habbakuk 2:1.

Mizpeh means also "watchtower." There are six different places of this name.

The Bible speaks of the *Migdol* time and again since that is the most common name for tower. It knows the following towers:

The tower of Edar, Genesis 35:21.

The tower of Gad, fortune, or fortune-telling, Joshua 15:37.

The tower of El, God, Joshua 19:38.

The tower of Penuel, Jude 8:17.

The tower of Shechem, Jude 9:49.

The tower of the watchman, II Kings 17:9; 18:8.

The tower of Meah, Nehemiah 3:1.

The tower of Hananeel, Nehemiah 12:38.

The tower of the furnaces, Nehemiah 3:11.

The tower of David, Cant 4:4.

The tower of perfumes for sweet flowers, Cant. 5:13.

The tower of Lebanon, Cant. 7:4, 5.

The tower of the flock, Micah 4-.8.

The tower of salvation, II Samuel 22:51.

The tower of Syene, Ezekiel 29:10; 30:6.

Since the Lord is a strong "Migdol," He represents them all. Proverbs 18:10.

From "migdol" we get the girl's name "Magdalene," "maudlin," Magdalene homes. "Maud," another girl's name.

DUKES-Genesis 36:15

Folk who read about all the dukes of Edom in Genesis 36 might be led to think that the modern dukedom, as that of the Duke of Windsor and other modern dukes, harps back to the dukes of the Bible; but if that were the case, then it would go back to the dukes of Edom only, since these dukes are mentioned only in connection with Edom forty-three times in Genesis 36, thirteen times in I Chronicles 1 and just once in Exodus 15:15, and never in regard to any other nation. In Psalms 55:13; Proverbs 2:17; Jeremiah 3:4; Micah 7:5 at the word "aluph" is rendered "guide;" in Proverbs 16:28; 17:9; "chief friends" and "friends;" Jeremiah 13:21 has "captains;" and it has been translated "governor" in Zechariah 9:7; 12:5, 6; and twice the word has been translated "ox," Psalms 144:14; Jeremiah 11:19 and that is the exact meaning of the word. The ox was in Israel the leading

and most useful animal which first in plowing and threshing gave the main pull and thus it became the symbol of a leader of the people. It became even the letter of the alphabet which once had the form of an ox head. The dukes of Edom then were only leaders of their people, and though the modern word "duke" coming as it does from the Latin "dux" leader, still means leader, it has in reality only become an honorary title.

ORIENTAL DRESS, JOSEPH'S COAT-Genesis 37:3

Dress in Bible lands means far more than with us as can be seen in the symbolical or metaphorical use made of the garments in the Scriptures. We wear them only for covering, warmth, and beauty but with the Easterners this is different. Clothing in the East always marks the social rank of the wearer today as it did in Bible times. The noblemen and courtiers wore *soft raiment,* Matthew 11:8. Most Orientals dress today exactly as in Bible days. If a man puts an old fashioned "nighty" on, he can walk in broad daylight through Cairo or any Eastern city and be in perfect style. A Mohammedan said: "The loose," wide, soft dress given to us by Allah is a token that we can do as we please: lie, steal, or adulterate, but you occidentals have a tight dress to show your tight morality and your fear of judgment of an angry God." What the Apostle says in Romans 13:14 and Colossians 3 of putting on Christ is a direct reference to the Oriental garment that covers the whole man. The idea of the Apostle is that we should thus cover our whole being with Christ and that the world should see us clothed, ensphered with Christ.

BAKSHEESH, OR I SEEK MY BRETHREN-Genesis 37:16

If the modern pilgrim to Palestine arrives home with one word unforgettably and indelibly stamped into his mind, it is the above word meaning *tip,* called by the Dutch *fooi,* by the Germans *Trinkgelder,* and by the French *pourboir.* In every place of the East the hands of the old and young are anxiously stretched out for *baksheesh.* It is this habit that greatly annoys every tourist. They evidently think that every American is a multimillionaire. They all seek something from him. This modern Arabic word heard in all the East and in the whole Mohammedan world is a derivative from the Hebrew verb *bakash,* "to seek." (Here used of Joseph seeking his brothers). *Bakkasah is* a request. The verb occurs in the Hebrew Bible over two hundred times, always meaning *seek,* while the noun invariably means *request.* Albert Schultens taught two centuries ago that the Hebrew came from the Arabic, but a sound philology knows now that the reverse is the truth and that the Hebrew is the older language of the two. It is a most remarkable fact that in this most used oriental word *baksheesh,* the seeking of the greater One than Joseph for His brothers after the flesh is reflected.

MOURNING IN ISRAEL--Genesis 37:29, 34

Mourning in the East is different from that in the West. We are content with weeping and some mourning garment, but the orientals are not content with this sobriety. In their excitableness they vociferate and howl in loud wails and lamentations, even in the solemnities of worship, Joel 1:13; Micah 1:8. They hire mourners for the very purpose of having louder lamentations and howls than they themselves can utter. They rend their clothes in frenzy, Genesis 37:29, 34; 44:13; II Chronicles 34:27; Isaiah 36:22; Jeremiah 36:24; Matthew 26:65; Mark 14:63. They smite their breasts, dress in sackcloth, Genesis 36:34; II Samuel 3:31; 21:10; Psalms 35:13; Isaiah 37:1; Joel 1:8, 13; Amos 8:10; Job 16:15. They cover their face and head, Leviticus 13:45; II Samuel 15:30; Jeremiah 14:4; Ezekiel 24:17; sprinkle dust or ashes on their head, II Samuel 13:19; 15:32; Joshua 7:6; Esther 4:1, 3; Job 2:12; 42:6; Isaiah 61:3; Jeremiah 6:26; Revelations 18:19. All ornaments are laid aside, Exodus 33:4; Deuteronomy 21:12; II Samuel 14:2; 19:24; Ezekiel 26:16; Daniel 10:3; Matthew 6:16, 17; cutting or plucking of the hair from the head or beard, Leviticus 10:6; II Samuel 19:24; Ezra 9:3; Job 1:20; Jeremiah 7:29; 16:6; fasting, II Samuel 1:12; 3:35; 12:16, 22; Ezra 10:6; Ezekiel 24:17; sitting or lying in silence, Genesis 23:3; Jude 20:26; II Samuel 12:16; Job 1:20; Ezra 9:3; Lamentations 2:10. The cutting of the flesh, Leviticus 19:28 and making baldness between the eyes was forbidden, Deuteronomy 14:1. Great sadness is often expressed metaphorically as follows:

The day turned into mourning, II Samuel 19:2.

My harp is turned into mourning, Job 30:31.

The oil of joy for mourning, Isaiah 61:3.

Our dance is turned into mourning, Lamentations 5:15.

I will turn your feasts into mourning, Amos 8:10.

Great joy on the other hand is often expressed in just the opposite way. The owls have a mournful and melancholy sound as if they utter sad cries of grief. The Hebrews had often listened to this sad hoot of the owl, and we read in Micah 1:8 of the "mourning as the owls."

JUDAH-Genesis 38:1

The name of the fourth son of Jacob is derived from a verb meaning "to hold forward," hold forth in the hand with the purpose to extol it, hence "profess," praise," "confess." The parents of Judas the traitor must have been a Godly couple to give their son such a beautiful name. Alas, instead of praising the name he betrayed it. This Hebrew word has greatly enriched our English vocabulary with the following words: Jew, Jewess, Jewish, Jewishness, Jewry, Judaskiss, Judaslike, Judea, Judaicial, Judaism, Judaize, Judaizer, Judeophile, Judaeophobe, Judaeophobia, Judaic, Judaization, Judas-tree, Judascolored red hair from the medieval belief that Judas had red hair. This was also the reason why the red-haired women in some parts of Europe were far from popular. I hope that the present Netherlanders do not have this notion, because their new Queen Juliana has dark red, auburn hair. In our land red hair is popular with many.

This chapter shows that Judah *went down* morally. Man's flesh always gravitates downward. The flesh will never be taken up, for flesh and blood cannot inherit the Kingdom of God. The mortal flesh must be swallowed up of immortality.

THE TAMAR, OR PALM TREE-Genesis 38:11

This tree is mentioned fourteen times in the Old Testament and then seventeen times more as the figurative and decorative palm tree in the temple where it is in each case called not *tamar* but *timorah.* Through the Arabic *Tamar Hindi,* Indian date, it became *tamarindus,* a leguminous tropical tree, the *tamarind. Tamarindus is* also used in medicine as a refrigerant and laxative. In all probability the *tamus* and *tamarisk* are also derived from the root *tam,* straight, upright, perfect. The palm once growing in all parts of Palestine has now well night disappeared owing to the many wars which ravaged the land and also to the idiotic policy of the Turks to tax high every tree. Jericho, once known as the city of the Palm trees, Deuteronomy 34:3; Jude 1:16; 3:13; II Chronicles 28:15; now shows only a few of these noble trees, planted within the last few years. The palms must have once flourished just outside of Jerusalem, since they plucked palm branches at the triumphal entry of our Savior.

The righteous shall flourish like the palm tree: deep, high, straight, evergreen, and under every circumstance in the desert of life.

THE BAKER-Genesis 40:1

Baker comes from the verb *aphah,* in which our *oven* can still be recognized. The prophet Hosea in 7:4 has a parable of the baker and his bread. The baker sleeps all night with the result that the oven is overheated and the cake is not turned but burned on one side and raw and doughy on the other side. The baker represents the sinful leaders who neglect their holy office and the people. The hot oven represents the hot sinful passions of the people, while the cake not turned emblematizes the unprofitableness of the northern Kingdom. Baking is one of the most ancient of all arts. The early Egyptians had bakers as we see. They often just baked upon coals, Isaiah 44:19. They baked bread and cake, leavened and unleavened bread, and all manner of bakemeats, Genesis 40:17. In Jeremiah's time the bakers seemed to be on one street, for we read of the baker's street, 37:21. However, we read far more of bread than of the baking of bread. In John 6 Christ gave a sermon on the true bread from heaven as the antitypical manna. All that eat this bread shall never hunger.

THE BUTLER-Genesis 40:1-23

The butler is literally one that constantly causes the king to drink. It is the hiphil participle of *shakah* to water, to give to drink. After tasting the wine himself so as to make sure that there is no danger of poisoning, he takes the beaker and holds it to the lips of the

monarch, and he holds it there till he has enough. He is not only a cupbearer of the king's cup as we would think from Nehemiah 1:11, but he gives the king to drink and holds the cup to his lips as a nurse today does it with her weak patient. The poor baker was killed but the butler's head was lifted up out of the prison according to the word of Joseph, and it was done on the third day. Blood flowed because of sin, but there was a resurrection on the third day in behalf of the elect remnant as represented by Joseph. Do not fail to notice that the baker was hanged on a tree, Genesis 40:19, 22; a wondrous shadow of blessed Calvary.

PHARAO'S CUP WAS IN MY HAND-Genesis 40: 11

Five times we read in this chapter of Pharao's cup, *kom*. Through Jewish influence this Hebrew word has become a part of the Dutch and other Germanic languages. In northern Holland, the Groninger dialect daily uses the word *kom* for cup, and the Yiddish speaking Jews also still use it for cup or pitcher.

Our whole present day etymology badly needs a radical revision, for as it is the Sanscrit, the Arabic, and the Celtic get the honor due to the Hebrew. Antisemitism in history and among the nations has not only manifested itself in bloody programs, but even in a senseless antagonism against the Hebrew language which in our days has experienced such a remarkable resurrection that it has absorbed modern culture and the chief classics of Western Europe. It has never happened before that a language, which had been practically dead for two thousand years, has experienced such a mighty revival as the Hebrew language has had in the last forty years. The Professors of Hebrew in the theological seminaries still break the heads of the students with the Hebrew as a dead language. They proceed upon the supposition that neither the Hebrew nation nor its language can have a resurrection. They do not believe Ezekiel 37.

THE NILE-Genesis 41:17

The Nile is the only river in the world that makes a country. If it were not for this marvelous stream, Egypt would be an uninhabitable desert. It annually overflows its banks to fructify the strip of land on each side and thus it makes fertile Egypt, which once could feed a starving world and was then known as the granary of the world. The word *Nile* is derived from the Hebrew word *Nahal*, stream, once pronounced *Neel*, and so the Greeks and Romans easily made it the Nile. The river was once simply known as the *stream* or *torrent* perhaps on account of the fact that it would overflow the banks and roll over the flat lands on both sides. To Egypt it was just the stream or river. All knew it and all venerated it. Everything in this river was worshiped as god: the crocodiles, the frogs, the fish, the ibis, and also the bulls, the cats, the apes, and the beetles on its banks. The worship of the white bull Apis was so delectable to the flesh that the Hebrews made an image of it upon the first occasion.

BOW THE KNEE-Genesis 41:43

Scholars are not agreed as to how to render the word *abrech* used here. Some make it an Egyptian word. Jerome thinks of a native Egyptian, and Roman scholars regard it sometimes as Joseph's naturalization; but *berek* is *knee,* and *barak,* bend the knee in praise, adoration, blessing.

Berakah is a blessing received on the knees. A *berekah is* a pool where cattle kneel to drink; such pools were esteemed a great blessing in a dry land where the flocks often suffered from lack of water. Thus the word here evidently means "bow the knee in respect and praise." Wilkinson in his "Ancient Egypt" says that the word *abrech is* still used in the present day by the Arabs when they command the camel to kneel and receive its load. There is therefore, no doubt whatsoever, that our version struck the correct translation of this word.

But what a wonderful type do we find here! Joseph, rejected by his own brothers was raised up from the dark dungeon and now all Egypt had to acknowledge that he was Lord indeed. After Christ's resurrection Peter said that all the house of Israel should know that He was Lord and Christ, and in the great day of His revelation every knee shall bow before Him, and confess that He is Lord to the praise of God the Father. Philippians 2:10, 11.

POTI-PHERA THE PRIEST OF ON-Genesis 41:45

Joseph took a daughter from the Priest of On. Our margin, the Dutch translation, and others have tried to cover this unpalatable fact by rendering it *prince* but the word *cohen* used over six hundred times is invariably translated *priest* and that is the meaning and never *prince.* We need not wonder that he took a wife from the caste of the priests. There were in the main three castes in Egypt: the ruling caste to which the priests belonged; the military caste; and the menial cast of the workers and farmers. Joseph was exalted from the lowest to the highest caste and if he wanted a wife at all, he would have to take one out of the ruling caste and the priests were not better nor worse than all the others in this idolatrous land. That Joseph did not escape contamination altogether is evinced by the fact that he used lecomancy, or divination and prognostication by means of a cup. The word *cohen* itself is in New York still the most common Jewish name. With several variations they have Cohen, Cohan, Cohin, Kahn, Cohun, Kohen, Kohan, Kohin, Kohun, Cohn, Can, Con, Cohne, Kohn, Kon, Kohne, etc., generally claiming that they are from the tribe of Levi, the sacred tribe of the priesthood, which may very well be true.

MESSAGES FROM PRISON-Genesis 41

It is interesting to note how often God has been pleased to send forth His Word and His secrets from the prison:

Joseph unfolded Pharao's dreams as from the prison which thus became a place of light and power for him, for Pharao, and for all Egypt.

For *Samson* it became a place of repentance, prayer, and growing strength.

Micaiah, the son of Imlah was vouchsafed a vision of evil spirits back of the false prophets.

For *Manasseh* it became a place of contrition, deep humiliation, pardon, and exaltation. Manasseh's sins had been frightful: sacrilege, spiritism, superstition, slaughter, stubbornness, but it was in the Chaldean prison that the grand turn of his life took place.

Jehoiachin got in prison the lifting up of his head, kind words, and a throne above the throne of the kings, new garments, and a royal daily portion.

Jeremiah, also, belongs to this galaxy of prisoners. He found himself time and again in the dungeon for his loyalty to the Lord, and he still speaks today in most eloquent tongue the important message: It pays to take the Lord's side in dark days of general apostasy.

Daniel in the den found the great angel stopping the lions' mouths.

For *John the Baptist* it became a place where he made Herod tremble and where he influenced this King to such an extent that he not only gladly heard the great preacher, but even did many things according to his word.

Barabbas was freed from jail because of the substitute Jesus taking his place.

For the *Jailor* it became a place of salvation for him and his house.

For *Paul* it became the reception hall where God gave him the great mystery of the Body of Christ in its absolute and eternal oneness with the risen Lord of glory through simple faith.

For *John* on Patmos it became a place of celestial visions concerning the great day of the Lord in which the windup of the present civilization shall make place for the glorious kingdom of Christ.

In church history we might point to Luther on the Wartburg, where he translated the Bible into German, to Bunyan who gave thence his immortal dream to the world, to Madame Guyon whose sweet meditations from her imprisonment are still the delight of Bible mystics. As a rule we do not expect much of a jailbird beside curses, groans, and smut, but these prisoners reached their hand through the bars and, especially Paul, gave us the greatest treasure of the ages, whispering into our ears that sacred secret which the wise and the scribes of this age never understand, but is the delight and certainty of our heart.

WE SAW THE ANGUISH OF HIS SOUL,
THEREFORE IS THIS DISTRESS COME UPON US

Genesis 42:21

Here is a classical passage for the smiting conscience and for the acknowledgment by the sinner of the principle of the *lex talionis,* or law of retribution, for the words *anguish* and *distress* are both expressed by the one word *tzarah,* a word used about eighty times to express *trouble, anguish, affliction.* It is the word for Jacob's time of trouble or the day of the Great Tribulation. When Adoni-bezek was caught and had his thumbs cut and was thus

deformed and sent under the table to pick crumbs, he acknowledged God's justice since he had done the same thing to seventy Kings. And so Jacob's sons have still the anguish of their young brother Joseph before their mind and they feel that God has retaliated with the same measure wherewith they meted. This Hebrew verb *tzarah* entered into the Greek as *teiro, rub, wear out;* it gave us via the Latin *tero, tritum* such words as attrition, contrite, contrition, detriment, detritus, tare, tear, trite, triturate, trituration, triturium, and also: deter, determent, terror, terrible, terrify, terrified, terrific, undeterred, and unterrified.

THY SERVANT BECAME SURETY FOR THE LAD - Genesis 44:32

The word *arab* is surety in the following places: Proverbs 6:1; 11:15; 17:18; 20:16; 22:26; 27:13; Job 17:3; Psalms 119;22: Genesis 43: 9. The word means *to come near* and *to meddle* and *intermingle* with two parties. This Hebrew word has entered into the Latin language and by way of that noble language has given us the following words: arbiter, arbitress, arbitrable, arbitrament, arbitrement, arbitrate, arbitration, arbitrator, arbitrary, arbitrariness, arbitrareous. Glory to God, our Christ has come all the way from heaven to mix Himself in with our unspeakable mess of guilt and filth, having identified Himself with man in incarnation and with believers on the cross. Judah is here in his surety and humble supplication in behalf of Benjamin a glorious type of our Lord Jesus Christ. There are conditional and unconditional sureties. The former are the human, who will only pay after the other party has tried and defaulted, but our Surety was unconditional. He knew that we were only a complete failure and He took upon Himself to take our place and thereby take all the penalty due us. Oh my soul, praise the Lord for His meddling with our total bankruptcy! Lest the word *meddling* here seem irreverent, we say *arbitrated* between God and man. He paid the arbitration price of His own all-adequate, all-cleansing blood on Calvary's cross.

THE WAGONS-Genesis 45:19-27; 46:5; Numbers 7:3-8

We read here nine times of wagons. The word *agalah* points to something which rolls or turns and does not say anything as to the form of these wagons. The same word is seven times rendered *cart* in I Samuel 6 and eight times elsewhere. Once in Psalms 49:9, 10 it is made *chariot* but the real word for chariot is *rekeb.* It is highly probable that these wagons in the Scriptures were only *carts,* two-wheeled vehicles. In Amos 2:13 God seems to compare Himself to a cart that is pressed by a full load of sheaves. In such a manner Israel pressed Him with the load of sins. To realize this we only have to look at the Savior in the garden and on the cross. Since Israel might not multiply the horses, wagons were of no use. Until the English came in Palestine, there were no wagon roads. All the traveling was done by donkey and camel or on foot. Wagons did not ride the pilgrims to the great feasts in Israel. God in this matter also clearly showed that He did not want His people to be like the other nations; and yet, it was the deepest desire of Israel to have Kings, gods, horses, and wagons like the other nations.

JACOB BOWING HIMSELF UPON THE BED'S HEAD

Genesis 47:31

In Hebrews 11:21 this word is quoted, saying, the Jacob "worshiped, leaning upon the top of his staff." A bed and a staff are widely different objects. The Hebrew *matteh* means rod, staff, sceptre, while *mittah* means a bed or bier. We must not conclude too hastily that one of he versions must be wrong. Jacob was resting on a *mittah,* a bed, and the dying patriarch must have leaned upon his *matteh,* stick. Some think it was Joseph's scepter, but it is better to take it as Jacob's own shepherd's staff. This humble staff once cut off from the living tree becomes here the emblem of the royal sceptre of Jacob, the royal sceptre of Him that was to come forth from Jacob. Jacob acts here as Prophet of glorious things in the far distant future. Why should he not similarly act as King in this solemn and official capacity? Our word *mat* is remotely related to the Hebrew mittah since the ancient beds were but little more than a mat. While many preachers systematically present Jacob as a mean crook, God portrays him in His Word as a perfect, tam, man in his life and as a sublime old patriarch in his death. Let us be careful not to degrade those whom God has put in His Westminster Abbey of holy fame.

SCEPTER--Genesis 49:10

The word *shebet* is used about 200 times and means *rod, staff, sceptre*, or *tribe*, since it was the insignia or sign of authority in the tribe. It was originally only a stick or rod, Ezekiel 19:11, 14.

The king was originally the man with the big stick. It is thought that it originated in the shepherd's crook or staff, since the first kings were mostly nomad princes, Leviticus 27:32; Micah 7:14. Diodorus Siculus records the fact that the sceptre of the Egyptian kings bore the shape of a plow while that of Osiris was a flail or crook. With swollen wealth and might they became golden with he Persian monarchs and an ivory sceptre was discovered at Nisnrud. The allusions to it in the Scriptures are practically all of a figurative and symbolical character in the sense of a symbol of royal power and right, Genesis 49:10; Numbers 24:27; Psalms 45:6; Isaiah 14:5; Amos 1:5; Zechariah 10:11. The use of it was evidently not confined to kings. At least in Jude 5:14 the expression "pen of the writer," should read "sceptre of the leader." The leaders of the tribes had big rods and these were sometimes regarded as a septre or the insignia of royal right and might. The iron sceptre of our Lord stands for His crushing judgments while His golden sceptre symbolizes His divine glory and reign as King of kings and Lord of lords.

A LION'S WHELP AND OLD LION--Genesis 49:9

The King of the beasts must have been very abundant in Palestine. It became extinct at the end of the twelfth century. The Crusaders met them yet in their day in the mountainous regions. The Hebrew has no less than seven words for lion as follows: *arieh, kephir, gur, labi, layish, shahal*, and *shahaz*. These words are descriptive to denote the lion generically and in different states and ages. Four words are used to express his varying roars, growls, and moods: *shaag, naar, naham*,

and *hagab* and there are not less than six words to denote his various movements when preying as prowling, pouncing, ambushing, and crouching: rabaz, shahah, yashab, arabh, zamas, and zinnek. Our lion stems directly from the Greek and Latin *leon* and *lion*, but these in turn borrowed it from the Hebrew *labi* and *layish*. The German *lowe* and the Dutch *leeuw* are of the family. Hence this Hebrew word enriched us with lion, lioness, lionet, lion's den, lionize, lion's share, lion-hearted, lionization. lion-hunt, lionhunter, lion-roar, lion's mouth, leontiasis, dandelion (meaning lion tooth), leonotis, and leontodon.

CHRIST IN GENESIS

Creator-Created all things by Jesus Christ, Ephesians 3:9.

Light-Let there be light. I am the Light of he world.

Sun-to rule the day. He rules and over-rules man's day.

Image-Let us make man after an image.

Adam-Christ is the antitype of Adam and the last Adam, I Corinthians 15:45-49.

Bridegroom-One flesh, Ephesians 5. This is a great mystery. Seed of the woman, 3:15.

Garment, came from life, blood, death. 3:20.

Abel-Being dead, he yet speaketh. Christ was dead and yet speaks.

Seth appointed in the stead of Abel. His name means set up and looks typically to resurrection after Abel's death.

Ark of safety, 6:14-16.

Burnt offering, pointing to His sacrifice on Calvary.

Bow, token of His covenant with creation; it antitypically appears several times in Revelations.

Blessing for all the nations, 12:3.

Abraham's seed, Galatians 3:16. Melchizedek, 14:18-20; Hebrews 7:2, 9, 10.

Circumcision, Colossians 2:11. The cross was the real antitype of this rite, and in Christ we have the real circumcision.

Angel of the Lord, 18:1-33.

Judge of all the earth, Matthew 19:24.

Isaac-He is the real laughter, for while He often wept on earth, He now sits in heaven and laughs.

Ram Revealed as Substitute-22:13

Ladder reaching to heaven, 28:12. He binds heaven and earth, God and man together. He reestablishes the broken union and communion. By Him we have access to the Father, Romans 5:2; John 1:51.

Levi, meaning joined. Christ is the antitypical Levitical priest who joins Israel to God.

*Joseph***,** beloved, rejected, hated, sold**,** put in the prison of death, raised, exalted, and saved his brothers.

Wrestler, 32:24-29 Jacob is called *tam,* perfect, Hosea 12:3, 4.

Israel, Christ is the real spiritual Israel, "My servant."

Drink offering, 35:14. The liquid was ever poured out before the Lord and never drunk. This pointed to His outpouring, Psalms 22:14; Isaiah 53:12.

Judah, the one praising God. Christ alone could truly say: "I have glorified thee on the earth," and: "I do always the things that please Him."

Ben-oni, the son of sorrow, 35:18.

Benjamin, the son of the right hand, so called by his father.

Surety, 43:9; Hebrews 7:25. There are two sorts of sureties: the conditional and the unconditional. Our Lord is the latter, thank God!

Salvation. Jacob waits for the great salvation of the Savior who will save Israel forever.

Shiloh, 49:8-10. Christ now gathers out a people for His name, but soon unto Him shall the gathering of all the nations be as unto the Prince of Peace.